THE 5-STEP BOOK LAUNCH

FOR EXPERTS

THE INSIDER'S GUIDE TO SELF-PUBLISH YOUR BOOK, NAIL YOUR LAUNCH, AND TURN READERS INTO **HIGH-PAYING CLIENTS**

KARINA G. SANCHEZ

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www.theroyaltycoach.com

To my kids.
You are the reason behind every early morning, every late night, and every page. Everything I do, I do for you.

*And to **every expert** who has spent years creating incredible results for their clients, one person at a time. Your work deserves to be seen. May the book you're writing fill your calendar with the people who have been waiting for you.*

INSIDE THIS BOOK

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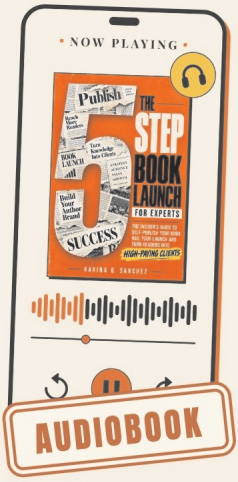
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Check out this video training and the overview of *The 5-Step Book Launch for Experts*.



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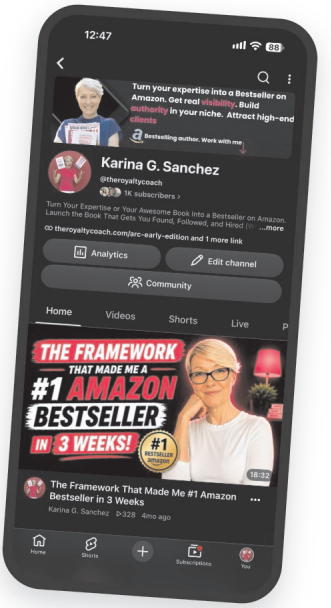
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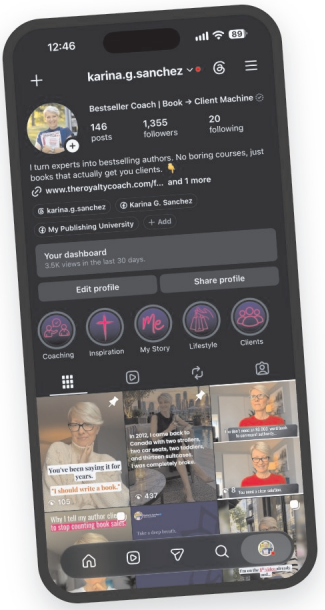
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SINGLE MOM, TWO SMALL KIDS, AND A BIG IDEA

When I landed back in Canada at 4 a.m. from Brazil in 2012 with 2 kids, ages 2 and 3, 13 pieces of luggage, 2 strollers, and 2 car seats, I didn't think I'd make it.

My very short marriage ended, and I wanted to come home. I became a single mom instantly. My days were full. My nights were fuller. My to-do list was longer than a grocery store receipt, and I was always exhausted.

But somewhere in the middle of all that, I kept thinking: *I need to write my book.* I spent years training leaders in South and Central America, in both Spanish and Portuguese, and I was really good at it. I knew that if I could just capture my method, the way I trained, the way I broke through to people, I would be able to help millions.

When I came back to North America, once again, I started training in the corporate world, this time, not as a consultant but as an employee. I wanted to build my knowledge base here. So while the kids adjusted to their new home and learned to speak English, I went to work. I commuted two hours each way and took care of my

kids. I was a rat on a wheel for eight solid years. And then, COVID happened, and we all got locked down.

As difficult as that was for many people, I want to be sensitive when I say this: It was the best thing that happened to me. All of a sudden, I gained hours in my day. Commuting and driving the kids was over. I still woke up at the same time, but now I used that time to write my book instead of rushing out the door.

I took a course, learned how to self-publish, and voilà! My book came to life.

FROM CORPORATE TRAINER TO MY FIRST BESTSELLING BOOK

As all training went online, I became an expert in teaching and training on Zoom. I took courses and polished my online training skills, creating activities that 10x the experience in my sessions. I didn't want to be a boring trainer. I wanted to be known as the trainer leaders wanted to send their employees to learn from.

I became known for my stuff.

I wrote my book whenever I could find the time. 5 a.m. Late nights. Nap times. Whatever pockets of time I could find.

And in less than three weeks on Amazon, it became a Bestseller.

SIX CORPORATE CLIENTS IN THE FIRST MONTH

On February 7, 2022, I was let go from my corporate training job. My department was cut, and soon after, the whole company was bought out. I was jobless and a little scared; I'm not gonna lie.

Funny enough, the day I was laid off was the same day I **hit publish on Amazon**, and my book went officially LIVE. This is the part that still makes me smile. God never closes one door without opening up another. I had a decision to make: Do I look for another job, or do I go back to consulting? I was in the middle of COVID, I was the only breadwinner, and I had two little ones to feed. I decided to take a deep breath, trust God, and let go of the J.O.B. mentality.

I promised myself *I would never go back to an office again*. I'm pleased to tell you that I didn't. From the day I made the decision to start my consulting business, I've worked from home, wherever that happens to be.

I believe that when you take a stand for your life and make what I call a *"no going back decision,"* that decision affects the molecular structure of the universe around us.

So, here's what that decision brought about:

In the first month after publishing, I signed six corporate clients to teach leadership. Six. In one month. I also landed a 4-year contract with one of the biggest publishing companies that literally took care of all my bills.

I didn't suddenly get better at selling. In fact, I still had the same level of sales know-how: zero. My book did the heavy lifting. People read it, *loved it, understood my technique, trusted me, and reached out.* My book became my business card. It became a door opener. I would send it ahead of time to the people I was meeting with. I gave away as many copies as I could at every event, autographed if possible. I made sure people left with my book in hand, and many times, they got two copies, an extra one for a friend.

MY BOOK BECAME MY BUSINESS CARD. IT BECAME A DOOR OPENER.

You know what happens to most business cards? They go straight into the trash bin, but a book sits on an office shelf, or a home office shelf, or someone's desk. It lives there, and sooner or later, it's read.

A QUARTER-MILLION-DOLLAR COACHING BUSINESS

From there, I grew a *quarter-million-dollar coaching business in the first year*. My superpower was leadership. I had a niche within it: Impostor syndrome in female leaders. And that's the key: Be so

hyper-niched that literally no one else can do what you do. People are so afraid of this. They think, *"The moment I niche, I cut most of my clients out."*

Nothing could be further from the truth. The moment you niche, you carve out your unique place in the world, and it's what you become known for. It's also how Amazon works: We sell more copies of our books by choosing niches hyper-focused on one audience.

I began to smell freedom. I had more time, and I got hooked on publishing, so guess what? I decided to keep publishing books. Before long, I had 15 Bestselling books and a ton more published. I raised the stakes. Now I want a $1 million self-publishing business and an even bigger coaching business. As I write this book, this is what I'm focused on.

I'm combining my two loves, education and people. I love to teach, train, speak, motivate, inspire, and coach. Nothing brings me more joy than being of service to others, changing lives, showing what's possible, especially to women. Because I get you. I've been there. I've been scared, fearful, anxious, tired, demotivated, and even hopeless. Maybe because I'm a person of faith, or maybe because I refuse to give up; either way, if I can do it, so can you.

PODCASTS, LEADERSHIP PANELS, AND SPEAKING GIGS

When you're a Bestseller, the invitations start coming. Podcasts. Leadership panels. Speaking gigs. Suddenly, you are relatable and important. People want to hear what you have to say. That's the power of a book. Doors opened that would have never opened to me otherwise. I became someone with something to say.

I was the same me. Same knowledge. Same experience I had before, but now I was an authority. That's the change. Now, I had weight. I could pull out that Bestseller and sign copies like they were going out of style, and you better bet your bottom dollar, I did. I carried boxes of my book in my car, ready and loaded. I even bought a Montblanc pen to autograph my books, because nothing says success like a Montblanc.

If you're going to autograph books, you better do it in style; that's what I say.

So, what changed? I had a book with my name on it.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

This book walks you through my five-step **P.R.O.V.E. Method.** You've spent years learning, doing, and helping people. Now we're going to put that expertise into a book that readers can understand, trust, and use, and give the people who need more help a clear way to work with you.

YOUR ROADMAP · 5 STEPS

THE P.R.O.V.E. METHOD

Expertise in, clients out. Come back to this page whenever you need to see where you are.

P

STEP 01

PINPOINT THE PROBLEM

Who do you help, and what do they need help with? We're getting specific here. Your book needs to speak to someone who reads it and thinks, "She gets me."

R

STEP 02

REVEAL YOUR METHOD

Get what you know out of your head and onto the page. We'll turn the way you help people into clear steps your readers can follow. You may think, "But I just know how to do this." Exactly. Let's show them how.

O

STEP 03

OFFER THE EVIDENCE

Give people a reason to trust your approach. Share examples, client stories, and results that show what your method can do. Help readers see how it could apply to their own situation.

V

STEP 04

VALUE YOUR EXPERTISE

Decide what readers can hire you to help them achieve. We'll build a paid offer with a clear outcome, scope, and price. You need to know what you're offering when someone finishes your book and asks, "How can I work with you?"

E

STEP 05

ENGAGE YOUR FUTURE CLIENTS

Get your book into the right hands and keep the conversation going. Use your launch, your teaching, and your follow-up to build relationships with people who could benefit from your help.

Along the way, we'll cover the practical work of writing, packaging, self-publishing, and launching your book. By the end, I want you to have decisions made, work completed, and a plan you're ready to put into action.

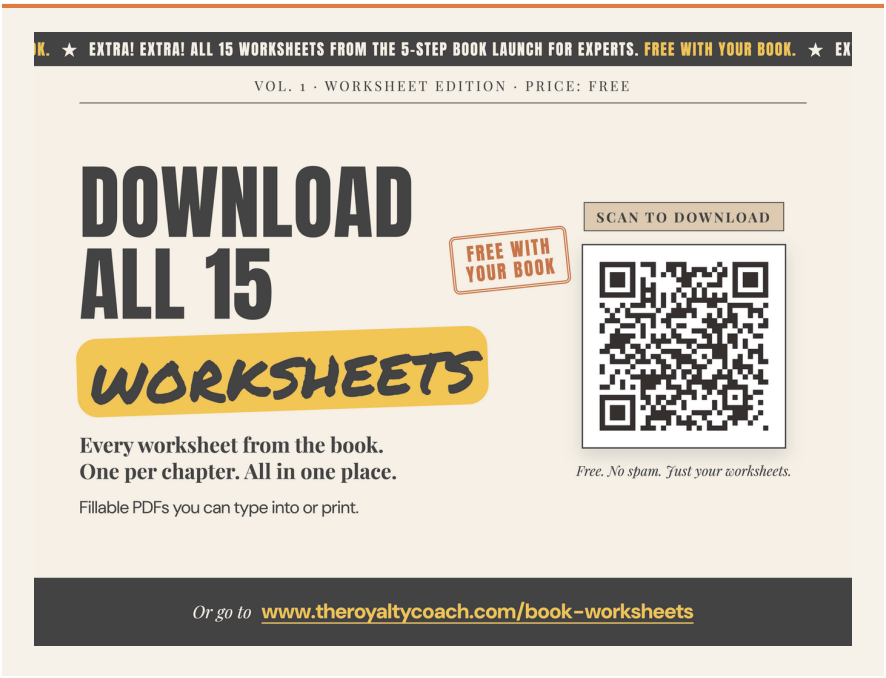
Each chapter ends with an activity. Please do them. Don't just read and nod. Reading about writing a book is like reading about going to the gym. It feels productive, but nothing changes.

Each chapter also has a free worksheet. You'll grab all 15 at once with the QR code below, and I'll point you to the right one at the end of each chapter.

FREE GIVEAWAY

DOWNLOAD ALL 15 WORKSHEETS

Let's start right now. Scan the QR code below to download all the worksheets you will use at the end of each chapter. There are 15 worksheets. The first one is your workbook, where you'll do each chapter's activity. The other 14 go with Chapters 1 to 14, one for each chapter. You will need each one.



Let's show them what you've got.

SEE YOU INSIDE!

— Karina

1

WHICH PATH IS FOR YOU?

TRADITIONAL PUBLISHING IS FOR FAMOUS PEOPLE

When I published my first book, I needed it to do something. I had two kids, bills to pay, and a corporate job that disappeared the same day my book went live. A beautiful book sitting on a shelf would have been lovely, but lovely wasn't going to take care of my family. I needed people to read it, *understand how I could help them, and pick up the phone.*

And they did. Six corporate clients in the first month. My book gave people a chance to get to know my work before we ever had a conversation. That's why I want you to think about publishing a little differently. You're an expert. You have something to teach, a problem you solve, and people who need your help. Your book should make it easier for those people to find you.

But first, we need to talk about the dream. You know the one where a publisher discovers you, falls in love with your ideas, and offers you a contract. They handle everything, your book lands in bookstores, and suddenly everyone wants to interview you. You buy a nice outfit for your book tour. Maybe a Montblanc pen, LOL. Listen, I understand the appeal. I bought the pen.

The trouble starts when we get so excited about being chosen that we forget to look at what we're agreeing to. Someone says, *"We want to publish your book,"* and suddenly the business owner in us goes quiet. The hopeful author takes over. Before you sign, take a breath. You worked too hard for your knowledge to hand over valuable rights simply because someone sent you a flattering email.

Now, is traditional publishing only for famous people? No. New authors get deals, too. But being known helps, especially when you're selling advice. If you already have an audience, speaking engagements, and people waiting for your next idea, a publisher has clearer routes to buyers. You may be excellent at what you do, but the publisher still needs to see how your expertise could translate into book sales.

That can feel frustrating. You're thinking, *"If I already have the audience, what do I need the publisher for?"* Fair question. A good publisher can bring editing, production, distribution, and experience you don't have. Those things have value. But you need to understand exactly what you're getting, because an impressive name on the spine won't automatically give you the business results you want.

Start with the money. In a conventional traditional deal, the publisher pays to publish your book. You shouldn't have to buy a publishing package to get that deal. If a company asks you to fund production, you're evaluating a different arrangement, regardless of what they call it. Get clear on that before you get excited about being "*accepted*."

You're still making an investment. Your time, for starters. Writing, revising, meetings, promotion, all of that has to fit somewhere between serving clients and living your life. Then there's the schedule. If your book is supposed to support a workshop or a new service, find out whether the proposed publication date works for you. Your business plans deserve a place in the conversation.

Then comes the contract. Please read it. All of it. I know. You teach leadership, coach people, or run a business; reading publishing contracts probably wasn't on your vision board. But this

document determines what you can do with your book long after launch day. Have a publishing-experienced agent or lawyer explain anything you don't understand. *"They said it was standard"* is a very expensive reason to skip a question.

Pay attention to which rights you're granting. In a typical trade deal, you retain copyright and license certain rights to the publisher. That might include print, ebooks, audio, particular languages, or territories. But owning the copyright doesn't mean you can independently publish another edition whenever you feel like it. The exclusive rights you granted still apply. You need to understand what you're keeping and what you're allowing someone else to control.

For experts, this gets personal very quickly. Your book might contain the method you teach in your workshops. Next year, you may want a workbook, a course, or another book on a related topic. Ask whether any non-compete or next-book provisions could affect those plans. You don't want to build momentum and then discover that your next move requires a conversation you never expected to have.

Ask what happens if things go wrong, too. What if publication is delayed? What if the publisher rejects the manuscript? When could you be required to return money? And how do you get your rights back if the book stops selling? A book can remain available digitally without doing much business. A useful rights-reversion clause needs to account for that. Get these answers while everyone is still happy to hear from you.

Now let's look at royalties, because percentages can sound much prettier than the payments they produce. Suppose your agreement pays 10 percent of a $20 cover price. That's $2 per eligible sale. But if it pays 10 percent of the publisher's receipts, and those receipts are $10, you get $1. Same percentage. Half the money. These are examples, but this is exactly why you ask, *"Ten percent of what?"*

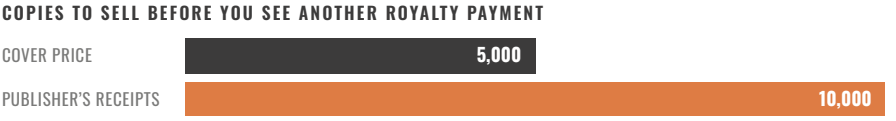
An advance also needs a little explanation. It's money paid against future royalties. If you receive a $10,000 advance and earn $2 per eligible sale, those first 5,000 sales earn out the advance before

additional royalty payments become due. Ask how different formats, discounts, and deductions affect the calculation. Have someone walk you through actual numbers. You should understand how you get paid before signing the agreement.

CHART 1.1

HOW ROYALTIES AND ADVANCES ADD UP

WHAT YOU'RE COMPARING	ROYALTY BASED ON COVER PRICE	ROYALTY BASED ON PUBLISHER'S RECEIPTS
Book's cover price	$20	$20
Amount used to calculate your royalty	$20 cover price	$10 received by the publisher
Your royalty rate	10%	10%
Your royalty per eligible sale	$2	$1
Royalties earned on 1,000 eligible sales	$2,000	$1,000
Advance paid against future royalties	$10,000	$10,000
Eligible sales needed to earn out your advance	5,000 copies	10,000 copies
When additional royalty payments become due	After royalties exceed the $10,000 advance, according to the payment schedule	



=10% SAME PERCENTAGE. HALF THE MONEY PER SALE. TWICE AS MANY SALES TO EARN OUT THE SAME ADVANCE.

Most small publishing companies don't offer an advance at all, so if you're going with one of those, you won't even have to worry about this.

BEFORE YOU SIGN, ASK

Is my royalty based on the cover price or the publisher's receipts? Do different formats have different rates? How do discounts and deductions affect my earnings? When are payments due? Have someone walk you through the actual numbers.

Illustrative examples assume the same royalty amount on every eligible sale. Actual calculations and payment timing depend on your contract.

A smaller share can be worthwhile if the publisher brings enough value. But for an expert, book royalties are only part of the picture. I gave away copies. I sent them before meetings. I wanted the right people holding my book. If that's part of your plan, ask about author-copy pricing and how you can use the content. A deal needs to support the way you intend to build your business.

And please don't assume marketing is magically taken care of. Publishers have marketing and publicity teams, but you need to know what's planned for your particular book. Who are they trying to reach? What will they do? What are you expected to do? "We're very excited" feels wonderful. It still doesn't tell you who's doing what on launch day.

You also need a way for readers to take the next step with you. A useful resource. A website they can find. A clear invitation to learn more about your work. Traditional publishing may be the right partnership, but look at the whole deal before deciding. You already know your expertise can help people. Now choose the arrangement that helps you get it into their hands and build the business you want.

SELF-PUBLISHING IS 100% FOR EXPERTS AND OTHER SERIOUS PEOPLE

The day I lost my corporate job was the day my book went live on Amazon. I didn't know six corporate clients were coming. I didn't know what the next year would look like. I had two kids, bills, and a decision to make. But I had finally put my method into a book that

people could read, use, and share. Years of experience had somewhere to go beyond the training room.

That's what I want for you. You already help people do something. Maybe you help leaders manage difficult conversations, parents navigate a challenging season, or business owners fix a problem that keeps them awake at night. You have explained your approach so many times you could probably teach it while making dinner. Your book gives that knowledge a way to reach people you haven't met yet.

Self-publishing lets you move forward without waiting for someone to decide you're famous enough. You can choose a subject because your clients need it, even if the audience looks small to a large publisher. My niche was impostor syndrome in female leaders. Being specific gave people a reason to recognize themselves in my work. Your book shouldn't interest everybody. It needs to matter to the people you can help.

YOUR BOOK SHOULDN'T INTEREST EVERYBODY. IT NEEDS TO MATTER TO THE PEOPLE YOU CAN HELP.

Now, when I say self-publishing is for serious people, I mean people willing to take responsibility. You become the publisher. You arrange the editing, approve the cover, review the finished pages, and organize the launch. You can hire help, and I strongly recommend it. I have a team of professionals that I work with, and when I work with you, you get access to them too. The freedom is wonderful, but your name is on the cover. Make sure the book represents the quality of your work.

YOUR BOOK BELONGS TO YOU

When you self-publish, you generally retain your copyright and choose the permissions you grant to platforms and service providers. At least, that's how it is for my clients. Read those

agreements. Some programs involve exclusivity, and paid help should come with clear terms about ownership and use. You want to know that you can take your manuscript, cover files, and other materials where you need them. *"I paid for it"* should never be your entire understanding of an agreement.

Think about what that ownership means for an expert. Your method might become a book today, a companion workbook next year, and a series later. You can plan those pieces around what your readers actually need. When clients keep asking the same follow-up question, you have something worth exploring. You don't have to squeeze everything you know into one enormous book and hope people make it to page 400. It's not realistic, and a book that long costs so much to print that you won't make enough in royalties.

You also have more control over keeping the material useful. Maybe your process improves. Maybe a resource disappears, an example becomes dated, or readers need a clearer explanation. You can revise your files and submit an update, subject to the platform's requirements and review. Updates won't rewrite copies already sitting on someone's shelf, of course. But future readers can receive a better version, and that matters when your book represents your current work.

YOU DECIDE HOW THE BOOK SHOWS UP

You choose the title, cover, positioning, and presentation. That's exciting until you have seventeen cover options and suddenly everyone you know has become a design expert. Remember who the book is for. Your favorite color isn't a marketing strategy. The cover and title need to help your reader recognize the subject and understand why it matters. We'll work on that in the packaging step, because a good book still needs a clear introduction.

You also decide how the book fits your calendar. You can plan toward a conference, workshop, or business launch, allowing enough time to produce it properly. Please don't turn that freedom into a race to upload something unfinished. Read the proof. Check the links. Look at the actual pages. You wouldn't walk into a paid

training session with half your materials missing. Give your reader that same respect.

YOU KEEP MORE OF EACH SALE, AND PAY THE BILLS

Self-publishing can give you a larger share of each sale, but "you keep your royalties" doesn't mean you keep the entire cover price. Platforms and retailers take their share, and printing or other applicable charges affect what remains. Editing, design, and advertising also cost money. Know your numbers. A book can sell copies while the author spends more than those sales bring in, especially when advertising enters the picture.

For experts, there's another calculation to make. My book earned its place in my business partly through the conversations it opened. I gave copies away because I wanted the right people reading them. You can do that deliberately, too. Budget for copies, shipping, and events alongside production. Track the inquiries your book generates. You want to understand what it contributes instead of assuming every expense will somehow come back as a client.

YOU'RE IN CHARGE OF GETTING IT SEEN

You can run your own Amazon ads, within the platform's rules, and decide what you're willing to spend. But please don't throw money at advertising because someone promised a bestseller button. Start with a budget you can afford, learn what the numbers mean, and watch the results. Advertising needs attention. If you hire someone to manage it, you still need to understand what they're spending and what that spending produces. I don't run my own ads. I have someone who manages them for me, and that's a really good option, especially if you'd rather focus on growing your clientele than setting aside time weekly to manage ads.

Your launch can also draw on relationships you already have. Think about the organizations you serve, the events you attend, and the people who regularly ask for your advice. Where would your book be genuinely useful? I sent mine ahead of meetings and carried

copies in my car. That worked as part of how I introduced my expertise. Your approach should fit your audience and the way you do business, but the more exposure you have, the better.

GIVE YOUR READER SOMEWHERE TO GO NEXT

This is the part I want you to think about before publication. Someone reads your book, loves your approach, and wants more help. Then what? Make the next step easy to find. It could be a workbook, a short video, or a resource that helps them apply what they learned. Where platform rules permit, you choose the relevant links and invitations that belong inside your book.

You've already seen me do this. I invited you to watch my video summary of this book because I want you to get familiar with who I am right at the start. A useful resource can also introduce readers to the rest of your work, with a clear choice about joining your email list or hearing from you. Keep the connection sensible. If your book solves a leadership problem, the next step should help with that problem. Don't send readers on a treasure hunt.

And give them real value in the book itself. People paid for help; help them. Teach something they can use, explain your method clearly, and let them experience how you think. Some will apply it independently. Others will want support. That's where coaching, consulting, training, or another appropriate offer can enter the conversation. You're making it easier for the people who need you to recognize the fit.

MAKE YOUR PUBLISHING DECISION

Before moving on, write down your answers: Do I want control over timing, updates, and related products? Am I prepared to fund professional production? Can I take responsibility for promotion? Do I know how this book supports my business? Would a particular traditional offer give me enough value to share those decisions? Be honest. Then use *"The Fine Print" cheat sheet* to review any agreement you're considering. You've worked hard for your

expertise. Let's make sure your publishing decision puts it to work for you.

ACTIVITY

TRADITIONAL VS. SELF-PUBLISHING CHECKLIST

Grab a pen. Don't just read this and nod; actually check the boxes. Be honest with yourself, because nobody's grading you except your future bank account.

PART 1: CHECK EVERY STATEMENT THAT'S TRUE FOR YOU RIGHT NOW.

COLUMN A

- ☐ I have a huge following (100,000+ people) who would buy my book on day one.
- ☐ I'm a well-known name in my industry, or in the media.
- ☐ I'm happy to wait two years or more to see my book in print.
- ☐ I'm okay with someone else choosing my title, cover, and price.
- ☐ I don't plan to use my book to get clients or grow my business.
- ☐ I'm fine earning about $1 to $2 a book, after the advance is paid back.
- ☐ I don't mind if I can't publish a workbook or a follow-up book without permission.

COLUMN B

- ☐ I want my book out in the next few months, not the next few years.
- ☐ I want to own the rights to my ideas, my content, and my book.
- ☐ I want to keep a bigger share of every sale and get paid every month.
- ☐ I want the final say on my title, cover, and price.
- ☐ I want my book to bring me clients, speaking gigs, and podcast invitations.
- ☐ I want to put my own links, QR codes, and giveaways inside my book.

- ☐ I want to update my book whenever my method grows.
- ☐ I want to publish more books, workbooks, or journals down the road.

PART 2: COUNT YOUR CHECKS.

If Column A won, congratulations, you might be famous, and I didn't even know it. Go knock on the big doors, and read every page of that contract before you sign it. If Column B won, welcome home. You're an expert with a business to grow, and self-publishing is your path. If it's a tie, look at the Column B statements you checked and ask yourself which ones you'd really be willing to give up. My guess? Not many.

PART 3: WRITE IT DOWN.

Finish this sentence in your workbook: "I'*m choosing* _____ *publishing because* _____." Keep it short and keep it honest. When doubt creeps in later, and it will, this is the sentence you come back to.

WORKSHEET

"THE FINE PRINT" CHEAT SHEET

Before you sign anything with anyone, whether it's a publisher, a "hybrid" company, or somebody who slid into your DMs promising to make you a Bestseller, grab my "Fine Print" cheat sheet from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. It lists the clauses to watch for, the red flags that mean "run," and the questions to ask before you hand over your book, your rights, or your money. Keep it next to you like a bodyguard for your book.

2

THAT'S YOUR AVATAR.

When I tell people to get specific about who their book is for, I can almost see them doing the math. *"But if I write for this group, I'm leaving out that group. And what about those people over there? They could use my help, too."* Before long, their book is for every person with a pulse and an Amazon account. Listen, I understand. You want to help people. So do I. But we need to give the right people a reason to recognize themselves in your book.

My area was leadership. That's a big subject. You could fill a library with books about leadership and still have more to say. Within that, my niche was impostor syndrome in female leaders. Now we have someone to talk to. A woman can be excellent at her job and still wonder whether she belongs in the room. When you understand that experience, you can write something that makes her think, *"How does this woman know what's going on in my head?"*

That's where we're going in this chapter. We're going to identify:

1. The person you want to reach,
2. The problem they want help solving, and
3. The method you use to help them.

Those three things will guide your book. Without them, you can spend months writing useful information that never quite connects. I want your reader to find you, feel understood, and have a clear reason to keep reading.

MEET YOUR READER

Imagine you're at an event. You have your coffee, your name tag is doing that annoying thing where it won't stay straight, and someone starts talking to you. A few minutes into the conversation, they describe a problem, and you think, *"Oh, I know how to help you."* Who is that person? What did they say? What made you recognize that your experience could make a difference?

Start there. Start with a person you could actually have a conversation with. In marketing, we call this your **avatar**: A practical description of the person you're trying to reach. You don't need to invent their favorite breakfast cereal unless breakfast has something to do with your work. You need to understand the situation they're in, what's difficult about it, and what they want to change.

For my subject, imagine a woman who has recently stepped into a leadership role. She knows the work. She earned the promotion. But she overprepares for meetings, second-guesses decisions, and worries that asking a question will make her look stupid. She might never say, *"I need a book about impostor syndrome."* She might say, *"I'm exhausted from feeling like I have to prove myself every single day."*

Pay attention to that difference. Experts often describe problems using the language of their profession. Clients describe what happened on Tuesday. They tell you about the meeting they dreaded, the conversation they avoided, or the decision they couldn't make. Those details help you understand what your book needs to address. They also help you explain your work in language readers recognize without needing a dictionary.

EXPERTS OFTEN DESCRIBE PROBLEMS USING THE LANGUAGE OF THEIR PROFESSION. CLIENTS DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED ON TUESDAY.

Now choose the main problem. Yes, this person has more than one. We all do. But your book needs a clear job. If you try to solve confidence, time management, marriage, money, and meal planning in the same manuscript, your reader won't know where you're taking them. Decide which problem you are equipped to help with and what useful progress could look like by the final chapter.

If you already have clients, review the questions they ask before hiring you. Look at your discovery-call notes and the feedback they've given you. If you're still building your business, talk to people in the group you want to serve. Ask what they've tried and where they get stuck. Listen before explaining your solution. You may discover that the problem you were planning to write about isn't the one they're most eager to solve.

ACTIVITY

CREATE YOUR IDEAL CLIENT AVATAR

Choose one real client or a realistic combination of people you understand well. Protect private details, and answer these questions in your workbook:

- What role or life situation are they in?
- What is the main problem they want help solving?
- How does that problem show up in an ordinary week?
- What have they already tried, and where are they stuck?
- What words do they use when talking about it?
- What would they be able to do differently after reading your book?

Finish with this sentence: **"My book helps _____ who struggle with _____ so they can _____."** Read it out loud. Could someone recognize themselves in it? If your answer includes "everyone," "anything," or "live their best life," take another pass. Give me a person, a problem, and a result we can understand.

THE "MY BOOK IS FOR EVERYONE" ERROR

"But my method could help lots of different people." It probably could. That doesn't mean you should address all of them in the same book. Think about how you choose a training session at a conference. You scan the options and look for something relevant to the work you're doing or the challenge you're facing. Your reader is making a similar decision. Help them see why this book deserves their time.

Imagine a new manager struggling to give feedback to employees who used to be her peers. She finds one book promising general advice for professional success and another focused on the difficult conversations new managers face. Which one gives her a clearer reason to investigate? Specificity helps people connect your book to their situation. They shouldn't have to read three chapters to figure out whether you're talking to them.

Choosing a niche also improves the writing. You know which examples to use, what needs explaining, and which advice belongs somewhere else. A first-time manager and an experienced chief executive may both need leadership support, but their situations can be very different. When you try to serve both equally on every page, you can end up staying so general that neither gets the practical help they came for, and that will earn you a bad review.

Your niche doesn't have to be defined only by age, gender, or job title. It can involve a stage, a circumstance, or a particular challenge. Think about business owners hiring their first employee, professionals returning after a career break, or consultants struggling to explain what they do. Choose details that affect the

problem and your solution. Being specific is useful when it makes your book more relevant.

And please don't confuse choosing your reader with refusing to help anybody else. Other people can still buy the book, learn from it, and contact you. You're simply deciding who gets your closest attention while you write. You can create another book for another audience later. Remember, we're building something you can grow. You don't have to fit your entire future business into your first manuscript.

On Amazon, you won't sell to everybody, and chasing everybody makes your job harder. Your title, description, and book need to make a clear promise to suitable readers. For an expert, those readers may also become clients, recommend you, or invite you to speak. A clearly relevant book gives those possibilities somewhere to begin. Large numbers are exciting, but the people behind those numbers matter.

WHAT'S YOUR METHOD?

Now that we know who you're helping, let's talk about how you help them. This is where some experts get strangely quiet. They can teach for hours, solve complicated problems, and answer questions without taking a breath. Ask them to describe their method, and suddenly it's, "Well, I don't really have one. I just know what to do." Stay with me. That's exactly what we need to unpack.

When I wanted to write my book, I wanted to capture the way I trained: how I explained things, helped people understand, and moved them toward applying what they learned. You may have something similar in your work. There are questions you ask, patterns you notice, and steps you return to because they help. Much of it may feel obvious to you because you've done it so often.

Think about the last time someone came to you feeling stuck. What did you ask first? What did you notice that they hadn't noticed? What did you help them do next? Perhaps you slowed them down before they made a decision. Perhaps you helped them practice a conversation or identify the real problem underneath their first

complaint. Walk through what you actually did, instead of jumping straight to the successful outcome.

Your method needs more substance than a catchy name. You can name it later. First, identify a sequence someone can follow: where they begin, what they need to understand, what they practice, and how they evaluate their progress. Explain why the steps belong in that order. If you regularly adjust your approach, explain what determines those adjustments. That judgment may be one of the most valuable things you teach.

And let's take some pressure off the word "unique." You don't have to invent an idea nobody in history has ever considered. Your experience, examples, explanations, and way of applying knowledge can make your approach distinctive. Be honest about what comes from established work and give credit where it belongs. Then show readers what your experience adds. You're allowed to build on good ideas while making your own contribution clear.

Ask what people consistently thank you for. Do you make complicated things understandable? Help them have conversations they've avoided? Turn a vague goal into something they can act on? Look for evidence across your work. Your method should connect what you do with the progress people make. That connection gives your book substance and helps prospective clients understand what working with you could involve.

ACTIVITY

METHOD BRAINSTORM

Choose three examples of people you've helped, keeping their information private. For each, write down:

- What was happening when they came to you?
- What did you ask, notice, or assess first?
- What actions or exercises did you guide them through?
- Where did they struggle, and how did you respond?
- What changed, and how did you know?

Compare your answers. Circle the steps and questions that repeat, then arrange them into a rough sequence. Give each step a plain-language description. Don't worry about making it clever yet. Ask yourself whether a reader could understand what to do and why it matters. You can refine the sequence as you develop the book; right now, we want your knowledge out of your head and somewhere you can work with it.

WORKSHEET

YOUR METHOD BRAINSTORM CHEAT SHEET

Open *Your Method Brainstorm Cheat Sheet* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to walk through three people you've helped, circle the steps and questions that repeat, and arrange them into a rough sequence. Please don't just read it and nod. Fill it in. You already have a method. This is where you find it.

3

You've identified your reader. You're getting clearer about the problem you solve. Now we need to find out what happens when that person goes looking for help on Amazon. Because you can write a wonderful book, give it a beautiful cover, and still make it difficult for people to find. I want you thinking about this before you spend months writing, not after you hit publish and wonder where everybody went.

Think about walking into a huge bookstore without signs. Leadership books beside cookbooks. Business advice mixed in with gardening. You know what you came for, but you have no idea where to look. Amazon needs information that helps it organize your book, and readers need language that helps them recognize it. This chapter is about making those connections. Get your workbook ready. We're going to do a little investigating.

NOT ALL TOPICS PRESENT WELL ON AMAZON

Something can work beautifully in a training room and be difficult to explain on a book page. In person, you have your voice, your stories, and time to clarify what you mean. On Amazon, a potential

reader sees a title and a small cover among other options. They may know nothing about you. Your topic needs to make sense without you standing beside the screen explaining why it's brilliant.

Suppose you teach a process you call "The Inner Leadership Shift." You know exactly what that means. A stranger might wonder whether it's about management, meditation, or changing careers. You can keep a distinctive name, but give readers enough context to understand the subject. A subtitle about helping newly promoted women lead with confidence tells them more about who the book is for and what they might gain.

Some subjects are also easier to demonstrate through video, practice, or personal guidance. That doesn't mean you can't write a useful book about them. It means you need to decide what the book can accomplish on its own. If your work involves difficult conversations, for example, you could include sample dialogue and preparation exercises. Give the reader something they can use without needing you to explain every page.

Then there's demand. You may care deeply about a topic, but you still need to investigate whether your audience looks for books about it. Search related phrases and examine what appears. Few relevant results could mean an opening, weak demand, or simply the wrong wording. A crowded subject could indicate reader interest and strong competition. Neither situation makes the decision for you. Look closer before declaring your idea a winner or throwing it away.

Remember, your book also has a job within your business. A specialized topic might be useful to the clients you reach through events, referrals, or training, even if strangers rarely search for it. That can still be worthwhile. Just be honest about how readers will discover it. If you plan to bring most of the audience yourself, build that into your launch instead of expecting Amazon to do all the introductions.

If you've read this far, you're serious about creating a book that fills your calendar with new clients.

At this stage, it's very important that you create your book correctly, so it does all the selling for you.

If you're ready to create a book that books you solid, book a call with me. We'll take it from where you are, create a plan, and get you published and your calendar filled. Book your call at calendly.com/karina-1-on-1/45min.

45-MINUTE DISCOVERY CALL

WANT A BOOK THAT WILL GET YOU BOOKED?

Fill your calendar with clients who ALREADY TRUST YOU.
No cold calls. No chasing or awkward DMs required.



SCAN TO BOOK YOUR CALL

Let's figure out where you're at and build your launch plan for a book you'll be proud to take to every meeting.

Or type this into your browser:

calendly.com/karina-1-on-1/45min

HOW THE ALGORITHM THINKS

Let's clear something up: I don't have Amazon's secret formula, and neither does anyone selling you a shortcut. Amazon says search results change automatically and can be influenced by factors including sales history, availability, time listed, and popularity. It also makes clear that neither Amazon nor KDP guarantees a top

position. So please keep your money in your pocket when somebody promises a permanent place at the top.

For our purposes, think about two questions. Can the right reader find your book? Once they find it, does the page give them a reason to consider buying? Relevant keywords and categories help describe the book. Your cover, title, description, and sample help the person evaluate it. Those are things you can work on. You don't need to understand every piece of Amazon's technology to make your book easier to understand.

Search position, sales rank, and category rank are different things. A book might rank well within a particular category without appearing first for a phrase someone types. Amazon also cautions that sales rank isn't an accurate way to track your book's activity or compare it with books in other categories. Use rankings as clues, and use your actual sales reports to track purchases. A screenshot of a rank tells only part of the story.

You know I enjoyed becoming a Bestseller. I bought the pen and carried the books. But I also wanted those books in the hands of people who could use my work. Keep that purpose in mind as you research. A ranking is exciting; reaching suitable readers gives your book a chance to do its bigger job. Make decisions you can explain in terms of your reader, rather than chasing a number you don't understand.

PICKING YOUR GENRE AND CATEGORIES

Your genre or subject tells people the broad kind of book you've written. For many experts, that will be practical nonfiction in an area such as business, leadership, or personal development. Categories are the more specific places Amazon uses to organize books. Start by asking where a reader would reasonably expect yours to belong. If someone browsing that section picked it up, would the content make sense there?

At the time of writing, KDP allows you to select three categories during book setup. Review the primary marketplace and audience settings, then explore the choices available for your edition.

Amazon recommends accurate categories and a balance between relevance and reader interest. Check the current options when you publish; don't build your plan around a category name someone mentioned in an old video.

Look at several books serving readers similar to yours. Which category links appear on their product pages? Follow those links and examine the neighboring titles. You're looking for a sensible fit, not an empty corner where a bestseller badge might be easier to obtain. Putting a leadership book somewhere unrelated won't help the reader who came looking for that subject. You want your book surrounded by a conversation it actually belongs in.

> **YOU WANT YOUR BOOK SURROUNDED BY A CONVERSATION IT ACTUALLY BELONGS IN.**

Write down your strongest category candidates and a sentence explaining each choice. That small exercise forces you to think. "My reader would look here because..." is a useful beginning. If your only explanation is "There aren't many books here," keep researching. You can revisit your selections, but start with a clear reason for placing your book where you do.

KEYWORDS YOUR IDEAL CLIENT IS ACTUALLY TYPING

Go back to the language you collected in Chapter 2. Your reader might describe a problem differently from the way you teach it. A professional term that feels obvious to you may never occur to them. Think about what they already know and what they might type while looking for a book. Start with possibilities involving their problem, role, or desired result, and treat those possibilities as ideas to test.

For a leadership book, phrases such as "first time manager," "difficult conversations at work," or "confidence for women leaders" might be worth investigating if they accurately describe the content.

These are examples, not researched promises of demand. Search each phrase in the relevant Amazon store, using Books or the Kindle Store, and examine the results. Are the books addressing the problem you mean, or does the phrase lead somewhere else?

As you type, notice any suggestions Amazon displays. They can give you additional wording to explore, but they don't tell you an exact number of searches or guarantee buyers. Keep notes about phrases that produce relevant books and language that fits your audience. You're gathering evidence to improve your choices, not trying to turn one afternoon of browsing into a perfect prediction.

KDP currently provides up to seven keyword entries and encourages relevant words or short phrases. Its guidance warns against misleading terms, other authors' names, unrelated book titles, and promotional claims. Use those spaces to describe your book accurately. Filling them with famous names won't make your expertise more relevant to the person you want to reach.

Keep your title readable, too. You don't need every possible search phrase squeezed onto the cover. Imagine introducing your book at an event and running out of breath halfway through the title. Let the title and subtitle communicate clearly, and use the available keyword fields thoughtfully. You can update keywords as you learn, so record what you choose and when you change it.

STUDYING THE COMPETITION

Please don't search your topic, find successful authors, and decide you're too late. You're investigating what readers already have available and where your contribution could fit. Choose five relevant books. Include some established titles and, where possible, newer ones addressing a similar audience. A celebrity's book may be interesting, but that author's existing reach can make it a poor model for your own launch expectations.

Study the promise each book makes. Who is it speaking to? What result does it emphasize? Look at the cover, description, available sample, format, and price. If the table of contents is visible, examine the progression. Notice how much context the reader needs and

how practical the teaching appears. You're learning about reader expectations while keeping your own approach and voice.

Then read a selection of positive and critical reviews. Look for recurring observations about usefulness, clarity, examples, depth, or missing guidance. One unhappy reader doesn't establish a market gap, and reviews don't represent every buyer. But repeated comments can suggest questions worth investigating. If readers keep asking for practical exercises, consider whether exercises would genuinely improve the book you're planning.

Finish by identifying what your book will contribute. Maybe you serve a different career stage, explain a difficult idea more clearly, or include a process readers can practice. Be specific. "Mine will be better" isn't enough to guide a manuscript. You need to know what you will deliver and why that matters to your reader. Research should leave you with clearer decisions, not another reason to postpone writing.

ACTIVITY

COMPETITOR RESEARCH WORKSHEET

Complete this worksheet for five relevant books. Record the marketplace, edition, and date so you remember what you were comparing.

CHART 3.1 · WORKSHEET

COMPETITOR RESEARCH

WHAT TO RECORD	BOOK 1	BOOK 2	BOOK 3	BOOK 4	BOOK 5
Book title, author, and link					
Intended reader and main problem					
Promise made by the title and description					
Visible categories					
Search phrase used to find it; sponsored or unsponsored result					
Format and price					
What readers repeatedly praise					
What readers repeatedly want more help with					
What your book could contribute differently					

After reviewing all five, write down three category candidates and up to seven keyword candidates to investigate further. Finish this sentence: **"My book will help _____ with _____ by providing _____."** Keep that sentence beside your Chapter 2 avatar. If your research has changed your thinking, revise both. That's the point of doing this work before committing to the whole manuscript.

WORKSHEET

HOW TO FIND YOUR AMAZON CATEGORIES AND KEYWORDS

Open your *How to Find Your Amazon Categories and Keywords* worksheet from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Have it open while you research. Please don't just read it and promise yourself you'll do it later. Choose your comparison books, record what you find, and make your first set of decisions. You can refine them as your book develops.

4

START WITH THE PROBLEM

When my book went live, I had years of training experience behind me. I knew how to teach leadership. I knew how to help people understand themselves and put new ideas into practice. But the people who hadn't met me didn't know any of that. My book gave them a way to experience my work before deciding whether they wanted to hire me. That's the opportunity I want you to see.

You have knowledge that could help somebody. The question is how to put it into a book that makes sense to that person and connects naturally to your business. That's why we're going to work through P.R.O.V.E. It gives you five steps to follow, starting with the decision that shapes everything else: which problem are you going to help your reader solve?

MEET THE P.R.O.V.E. METHOD

P.R.O.V.E. stands for:

P	R	O	V	E
PINPOINT THE PROBLEM	REVEAL YOUR METHOD	OFFER THE EVIDENCE	VALUE YOUR EXPERTISE	ENGAGE YOUR FUTURE CLIENTS

Each step has a job. Together, they help you explain what you do, teach it clearly, establish trust, and create a path for interested readers to work with you. We will tackle the publishing and launch decisions along the way.

With P, you choose a specific problem for a specific reader. With R, you turn your knowledge into steps that person can understand and apply. With O, you show examples and evidence that support your teaching. With V, you define the paid help you offer. With E, you reach readers, build relationships, and invite suitable people to continue with you.

Notice where we begin. We haven't chosen a cover or planned a launch party. Those things are coming, and yes, you can get excited about them. First, your book needs a clear purpose. If you skip this decision, you can spend weeks writing chapters that are individually useful but don't belong together. Then you're stuck trying to organize a manuscript that keeps changing direction.

By the end of this chapter, I want you to have **one reader, one main problem, and one realistic promise**. Write them down. Keep them where you can see them while working. Whenever you wonder whether something belongs in your book, come back to those three decisions. They will save you from including everything you've ever learned simply because you happen to know it.

WHAT YOUR CLIENTS SAY WHEN THEY THINK NOBODY'S LISTENING

Your clients may sound confident when they're introducing themselves at an event. They have the title, the experience, and the

professional smile. Listen a little longer, though, and you may hear what's difficult. *"I spend Sunday worrying about Monday." "My team brings every decision to me.""I got promoted, but I still feel like somebody made a mistake."* There's a book problem hiding in those conversations.

Think about my niche: Impostor syndrome in female leaders. Imagine a woman preparing to present to senior management. She knows the material, but she keeps rewriting her slides. She rehearses every possible question and sleeps badly the night before. Telling her to "step into her potential" doesn't show much understanding of that experience. Describing the situation accurately gives her a reason to listen.

You need to know how the problem shows up during an ordinary week. What does your reader avoid? What do they spend too long doing? What conversation do they keep postponing? Ask people in your audience and listen to their answers. Don't rush to explain your method. You're trying to understand what they need, including the parts they may describe differently from you.

Review questions from your workshops, discovery calls, and client feedback. Look for patterns, while keeping personal information private. One dramatic story can grab your attention, but repeated concerns can tell you more about what your audience needs. Capture the language people actually use. It will help you write explanations that sound like they belong in your reader's world.

YOU CAN SOLVE PLENTY OF PROBLEMS. PICK ONE FOR THIS BOOK.

This is where experienced experts can get themselves into trouble. You see how everything connects. Confidence affects communication. Communication affects leadership. Leadership affects performance. Suddenly, you're writing about workplace culture, relationships, productivity, and childhood experiences. Listen, those connections may be real. Your reader still needs a book they can follow without wondering how they ended up three subjects away from where they started.

Choose one main problem and let supporting topics earn their place. Suppose you're helping newly promoted managers give useful feedback to former peers. You might include preparation, boundaries, and handling a defensive response. Each supports the central task. A long chapter about building a personal brand probably belongs elsewhere, even if it's one of your favorite things to teach.

CHOOSE ONE MAIN PROBLEM AND LET SUPPORTING TOPICS EARN THEIR PLACE.

A clear focus also helps you recognize when you've finished. You can ask whether you've given the reader what they need to make the promised progress. Without that focus, there's always another chapter you could add. Save those extra ideas in a separate document. You're building a body of work, and some ideas deserve their own book, workshop, or resource.

WHY DOES YOUR READER WANT HELP NOW?

People can live with a frustrating problem for years. What makes them ready to do something about it? Perhaps they've accepted a promotion, lost an opportunity, or become exhausted by a repeating pattern. Urgency doesn't require a catastrophe. Sometimes it's the moment someone thinks, "I cannot keep doing this every week." Understand that moment without exaggerating their fear or manufacturing pressure.

Ask what they've already tried. Have they read advice but struggled to apply it? Do they know what to say but freeze during the conversation? Have they followed an approach that didn't fit their circumstances? Those answers help you decide what your teaching needs to include. More information won't necessarily help someone whose main difficulty is putting familiar advice into practice.

Then consider the cost of leaving the problem unresolved. It might involve wasted time, missed opportunities, strained relationships, or constant second-guessing. Use the consequences your audience actually describes. You don't need to invent a dramatic financial loss to make the subject important. A recurring difficulty that affects someone's working day can be reason enough for them to want practical help.

MAKE A PROMISE YOUR BOOK CAN KEEP

Your promise explains what readers can reasonably gain by applying your material. Be specific enough to guide the writing. *"Become an amazing leader"* gives you very little direction. *"Prepare for and lead a difficult feedback conversation"* tells you what to teach, which examples to choose, and what an exercise should help someone practice. A manageable promise can still address something deeply important.

Be honest about what depends on other people or circumstances. You can teach someone to prepare a conversation; you can't guarantee how their employee will respond. You can help readers practice a skill; reading alone won't establish mastery. Explain the effort involved and give them ways to assess progress. Your credibility grows when your teaching and your promise match.

Make sure the promise connects to expertise you can genuinely offer. If readers need additional support, could you help them apply the method through coaching, consulting, or training? That connection gives your book a sensible place in your business. Still, deliver useful help inside the book. People should be able to benefit even if they never purchase anything else from you.

Before you move on, check whether your promise describes something your reader wants or something you wish they wanted. There can be a difference. Experts sometimes jump ahead to the deeper issue before acknowledging the immediate frustration. Meet your reader where they are, then help them understand what needs to change. That gives your teaching somewhere familiar to begin and makes the next step easier to explain.

ACTIVITY

DEFINE YOUR BOOK'S PROBLEM AND PROMISE

Take out your workbook and answer these questions:

- Who is the specific reader for this book?
- What problem do they describe in their own words?
- Where does it show up during their week?
- Why do they want help now?
- What have they tried, and what remains difficult?
- What progress can your book realistically help them make?

Now complete this sentence: **"My book helps _____ address _____ so they can _____."** Test it with people who fit your audience. Ask what they think the book would help them do. If their answers differ wildly from your intention, clarify the wording. Keep your notes; we will use this promise when developing your title, outline, and description. Bring this sentence into your next client conversation and listen carefully before deciding you've got it right.

WORKSHEET

P.R.O.V.E. METHOD PLANNING WORKSHEET AND READER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Open your *P.R.O.V.E. Method Planning Worksheet and Reader Interview Questions* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Complete the P section first and use the questions to check your assumptions with potential readers. You don't need perfect answers today. You need a starting point supported by conversations. Let's give your expertise a specific job to do.

CHAPTER 5

Imagine putting years of experience into a book, then giving it a title that nobody understands and a cover that looks like you made it during lunch. You know the content is good. Your clients know you're good. But the person scrolling through Amazon doesn't know you yet. They have a small image, a few words, and plenty of other books to consider.

That's why packaging matters. Your title, subtitle, cover, and description introduce your work before the reader experiences your teaching. They need to communicate the promise you developed in Chapter 4. You're helping someone recognize that this book addresses something they care about. Get that clear, and you've given them a reason to investigate. Make them work too hard, and they may keep scrolling.

YOUR TITLE HAS A JOB TO DO

Naming your book can bring out a surprisingly emotional side of you. You find a phrase you love and start imagining it on everything. The cover. Your website. A mug. Then somebody asks what the book is about, and you need five minutes to explain. Listen, you can love a

title and still need to change it. Your reader needs enough clarity to get interested.

LISTEN, YOU CAN LOVE A TITLE AND STILL NEED TO CHANGE IT. ”

Start with the problem and promise you wrote down. What language would help your reader recognize the subject? Which words connect with the situation they're in? Write several possibilities before choosing. Try a direct title, a phrase your audience uses, and a distinctive title supported by an explanatory subtitle. Give yourself room to explore instead of defending the first idea that made you smile.

Look at this book: *The 5-Step Book Launch For Experts*. You know we're talking about a book launch, you know there's a process, and you know who it's intended for. The title gives us somewhere useful to begin. It doesn't explain every chapter, and it doesn't need to. That's what the rest of the packaging is there to help communicate.

Test your candidates with people who resemble your intended reader. Ask, "What would you expect this book to help you do?" Their answers are more useful than whether they think the title sounds nice. Your best friend may love everything you create. Lovely friend. Possibly not your strongest source of feedback. Find people who understand the problem and let them respond before you explain.

LET YOUR SUBTITLE EXPLAIN THE PAYOFF

A subtitle gives you more room to connect the topic to the reader's needs. If your main title is intriguing but broad, the subtitle can explain who the book serves and what it helps them accomplish. If the title is already direct, the subtitle can add useful detail about the approach or benefit. Every part should contribute something the reader needs.

For this book, the subtitle is ***The Insider's Guide to Self-Publish Your Book, Nail Your Launch, and Turn Readers Into High-Paying Clients.*** It connects publication with the business opportunity behind it. An expert can see why this subject matters beyond holding a finished book. Your subtitle should make a similar connection between what you teach and why your reader wants to learn it.

Be careful with the promise. Enthusiasm can turn a useful subtitle into something you couldn't possibly deliver. If you teach preparation and practice, don't imply that reading guarantees an outcome you can't control. Describe the benefit honestly. You want the reader to recognize the promise again inside the book and feel that your teaching supports what brought them there.

Try completing this sentence: "A practical guide for [reader] to [result] using [approach]." That's a drafting tool, not a formula you must print. Use it to identify the information that matters, then write something natural. Read your title and subtitle aloud together. If you're repeating yourself or running out of breath, edit. Clear language usually gives you more than adding another impressive adjective.

YOUR FAVORITE COLOR ISN'T A COVER STRATEGY

I bought a Montblanc pen because I wanted to autograph my books in style. I understand wanting your book to feel like you. But the cover also needs to make sense to your reader. Your favorite color can be part of a good design. It can't be the entire reason for choosing one. Ask what the finished cover communicates about the subject, tone, and audience.

Return to the books you studied in Chapter 3. Look at how they use type, imagery, color, and space. What helps you recognize the subject? Which covers stay readable when they're small? You're gathering context for your own decisions. Keep your design original while understanding the expectations your reader may bring to this kind of book.

Give your designer a useful brief. Include the intended reader, the problem, the promise, the exact title and subtitle, and examples of

covers with an explanation of what you like. Describe the feeling you want: practical, encouraging, authoritative, or another quality that fits your teaching. "Make it pop" leaves a lot to interpretation. Explain what the design needs to accomplish.

Check each proposed cover at a small size, similar to what someone might see while browsing. Can you read the main title? Is the imagery clear? Does the design feel crowded? Then inspect the full cover for your chosen format, including the spine and back where applicable. Before approving print production, review a physical proof. Something can look beautiful on a screen and need adjustment on paper.

WRITE A DESCRIPTION THAT MAKES PEOPLE WANT TO READ

Your description continues the conversation the cover started. Someone is interested enough to look closer. Help them understand whether the book suits their situation. Open with a recognizable problem or a clear statement of who the book helps. You don't need to begin with your entire professional history. Give the reader a reason to care about the content first.

Imagine a book for newly promoted managers. An opening might say, "You earned the promotion. Now you need to lead people who were your peers, give feedback without avoiding the hard parts, and stop carrying every decision yourself." That tells a particular reader you're addressing their experience. They can quickly decide whether the book sounds relevant.

Next, explain what the book will help them understand or do. Choose a few meaningful outcomes rather than listing every topic. "Learn how to prepare a feedback conversation" is clearer than "Unlock communication excellence." You already know how to explain your work to a client. Bring that same directness to the description and give people something concrete to evaluate.

Add a concise reason to trust your guidance. Relevant experience, an accurately described method, or a supported result can help. Use what you can honestly substantiate. Then close with a simple invitation to read. Check that the description matches the actual

manuscript. Nobody should buy a practical workbook and discover that the exercises exist only in your imagination.

Do one final check across all four pieces. If the cover suggests a gentle introduction, the subtitle promises advanced techniques, and the description targets beginners, you've created three different expectations. Choose the experience you're actually delivering and align the language and design around it. This is also a good moment to check spelling, punctuation, and consistency in your name and book title. Small mistakes are easier to fix now than after you've ordered copies for an event or client meeting.

✎ ACTIVITY

CREATE YOUR BOOK PACKAGING BRIEF

Bring together the decisions you've made so far. This brief will help you evaluate your options and explain the project to a designer, editor, or anyone assisting you. Complete it before asking for opinions, so feedback can focus on whether the packaging serves your reader.

- My intended reader is:
- The problem my book addresses is:
- The progress readers can reasonably expect is:
- My three strongest title options are:
- My proposed subtitle is:
- The tone and feeling my cover should communicate are:
- Three reference covers, and what I find useful about each, are:
- My draft description is:

Show the title, subtitle, cover concept, and description together to a few suitable readers. Ask what they expect to find inside, which parts feel relevant, and what seems unclear. Listen for patterns. You don't have to accept every suggestion, but you should investigate repeated confusion. Revise the brief before committing to the final design.

WORKSHEET

TITLE, SUBTITLE, AND BOOK DESCRIPTION TEMPLATES

Open your *Title, Subtitle, and Book Description Templates* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use them to develop options, then read each version as if you were encountering your book for the first time. Does it sound like you? Does it speak to the reader you chose? Is the promise clear?

You don't need packaging that everybody loves. You need packaging that helps the right people understand why this book deserves their attention. Take the time to get that introduction right. In the next chapter, we'll work on the method behind the promise, so the experience inside your book delivers on what the outside has offered.

6 OF 6

When I wanted to write my first book, I knew I had something to teach. I had spent years training leaders in Spanish and Portuguese, then continued that work in North America. Put me in a room with people, and I could teach. Turning that experience into something a reader could follow without me standing there was a different assignment. I needed to capture how I helped people learn.

You may be facing the same thing. Clients ask questions, and you know where to begin. You notice something they missed, explain what matters, and help them take action. Then somebody asks you to describe your method, and suddenly you sound less certain. "Well, it depends. I just know what to do." Stay with me. We're going to slow that knowledge down enough to put it on paper.

YOU DO THIS EVERY DAY. LET'S FIGURE OUT HOW.

We've reached R in the P.R.O.V.E. Method: Reveal Your Method. You've chosen the problem your book addresses and started shaping its promise. Now we need to show readers how to make progress. A method gives them a path through your teaching. It explains what to

consider, what to do, and how to recognize whether they're ready for the next step.

A METHOD GIVES THEM A PATH THROUGH YOUR TEACHING.

Start with work you've done. Go back to the three people from your Chapter 2 Method Brainstorm. If one of them doesn't fit the problem your book will address, swap in someone who does. Use your notes, teaching materials, or memory to reconstruct what happened, protecting private information. Don't begin with the successful outcome and skip everything in between. We need the questions you asked, the decisions you made, and the actions you guided.

Suppose you help new managers give difficult feedback. Imagine a client arriving with, "I need to tell my employee their attitude is terrible." You probably wouldn't hand them that sentence and send them into the meeting. You might ask what happened, separate observable behavior from assumptions, and clarify what needs to change. Those questions already reveal part of your approach.

Next, you might help them prepare specific examples, practice an opening, and decide how to follow up. Write that down. What feels obvious to you may be exactly what your reader needs explained. Expertise can make you forget how many small decisions sit inside an action you now perform comfortably. Your job is to make those decisions visible.

Compare your three situations. Which questions and actions repeat? Where do you begin? What do you check before moving forward? Look for the structure underneath your adjustments. You don't need every client experience to be identical. You need to identify the parts of your approach that reliably guide your work and understand when you do something differently.

PUT THE STEPS IN AN ORDER PEOPLE CAN FOLLOW

Now give those repeated actions a sensible order. Your reader needs a starting point that matches their current understanding. They may arrive confused, frustrated, or convinced they already know the answer. Decide what they need to understand before taking action. If you ask them to practice a conversation before identifying the issue, they could rehearse the wrong message beautifully.

For our manager example, a draft sequence might be: identify the behavior, clarify the expectation, prepare the conversation, practice the opening, and agree on follow-up. That's an illustrative framework, not a universal prescription. Notice how each step prepares for another. You can explain why it belongs there and what the reader should have ready when they finish it.

Give each step three things: a purpose, an action, and a useful output. In the preparation step, the purpose might be to keep the discussion specific. The action could involve writing down examples and the expected change. The output would be a short conversation plan. That gives your reader something to work with beyond "communicate more effectively."

Be careful about squeezing your process into five steps simply because five looks attractive on a cover. Your method may need three steps or seven. Some steps may repeat as the reader learns more. Choose the structure that helps people apply your expertise. You can simplify the presentation once you understand the work, without removing something essential.

Test the sequence by walking through it with a situation. Can someone begin without information you haven't provided? Does each instruction lead somewhere useful? Are you asking for a decision without explaining how to make it? Wherever you find yourself saying, "Obviously, they would know that," pause. Your reader might be opening this book precisely because they don't.

NAME YOUR METHOD WITHOUT MAKING IT COMPLICATED

Once the process makes sense, you can think about its name. This part can be fun. You're giving people a way to remember your approach and talk about it. But please don't spend three days searching for a word beginning with Q because you've fallen in love with an acronym. The name should help explain the work you've already organized.

P.R.O.V.E. gives this book a memorable structure. Each letter points to an action connected to the larger goal: turning your expertise into a book and a business people can understand and trust. That connection matters. If readers remember the letters but can't explain what they're supposed to do, the acronym hasn't done enough.

You can also choose a straightforward name, such as "The Feedback Preparation Process," while you develop something more distinctive. Say the name aloud and explain it to someone unfamiliar with your work. Ask what they think it means. You want language you can use in a workshop, a client conversation, and your book without delivering a separate lecture about the name.

Remember what we said in Chapter 2 about the word "unique." You're allowed to build on good ideas. Give credit to your sources and make your own contribution clear.

SHOW WHERE PEOPLE GET STUCK

The first version of a method often assumes a cooperative reader. They understand every instruction, complete every exercise, and move forward with enthusiasm. Wouldn't that be lovely? Real people hesitate, misunderstand, skip things, and get interrupted. Your experience becomes especially useful when you anticipate those moments and explain how to handle them.

Return to the feedback example. A reader may struggle to identify specific behavior because they're upset. Another may write a useful plan but avoid scheduling the meeting. Those are different obstacles. The first person might need help separating observation

from interpretation. The second might need to identify what they fear and prepare for that possibility. "Just follow the steps" won't address either difficulty.

For every stage, ask what commonly goes wrong and what you do when it happens. Add a question, example, or exercise that helps the reader respond. Also explain when your method doesn't fit or when additional support is needed. Boundaries make your teaching more useful because readers can judge whether they're applying it to an appropriate situation.

Build in ways to check progress. After preparing feedback, can the reader describe the behavior without assigning a motive? Can they explain the expected change clearly? These checks let someone evaluate their work before proceeding. Choose measures that fit your subject. You're helping readers make better decisions independently, using the judgment you normally bring into the room.

ACTIVITY

MAP YOUR SIGNATURE METHOD

Open your workbook and choose one problem your book promises to address. Use your three client situations to draft the process below. Keep the language simple enough that a reader could explain each step back to you.

- **Starting point:** What is happening when the reader needs your help?
- **Desired progress:** What should they understand or do by the end?
- **Sequence:** What actions belong in the process, and in what order?
- **Purpose:** Why does each step matter?
- **Output:** What will the reader produce, decide, or practice?
- **Obstacles:** Where might they struggle, and what would help?

- **Progress checks:** How can they assess their work before continuing?

Give the draft to someone who resembles your reader. Ask them to talk through the process and identify what feels unclear. Resist explaining every gap immediately. Their questions show you where the method needs more support. Revise the sequence, then give it a name. You can refine that name after the teaching is solid.

WORKSHEET

METHOD MAPPING WORKSHEET

Open your *Method Mapping Worksheet* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to lay out the sequence, examples, and progress checks in one place. Bring your Chapter 4 promise with you and make sure the method actually supports it. We're building the substance your reader came for.

You've spent years knowing what to do next. Now you're making that knowledge easier for someone else to follow. In the next chapter, we'll turn this process into an outline and chapters that move your reader forward. Keep your map nearby. It will help you decide what to write and what belongs somewhere else.

7

When I came back to North America, writing my book had to fit around working and raising my kids. For years, there was commuting, rushing, and a to-do list that never seemed to get shorter. When COVID changed our routines, I finally had hours I could use differently. I kept waking up early, but now I could write instead of heading out the door. Those hours became an opportunity.

You may have a different schedule, but you still need somewhere to begin. By now, you have your reader, your promise, and a draft of your method. That's a lot more useful than staring at a blank document and hoping inspiration will take over. In this chapter, we're going to turn those decisions into a structure you can write and a book your reader can follow.

BUILD YOUR OUTLINE AROUND THE READER'S PROGRESS

Your method map from Chapter 6 gives you the foundation. Start by asking what readers need to understand or do first, then what comes next. A chapter should move them somewhere. It might help them

recognize a pattern, make a decision, practice a skill, or prepare for a later step. Give each chapter a job before filling it with material.

You don't need one chapter for every step of your method. A complicated step may need two chapters, while a simpler one may fit within another. Let the amount of teaching determine the space. The goal is a manageable progression. If readers must understand a concept before completing an exercise, teach it before asking them to do the work.

For our feedback example, you could begin by helping managers identify the specific issue, then address preparation, delivery, and follow-up. Under each chapter title, write what the reader should leave with. "A clear description of the behavior" tells you more than "Understand feedback." It also helps you decide which stories, explanations, and exercises belong in that chapter.

Keep the outline flexible while you test it. You may discover that one chapter repeats another or that you skipped an important explanation. Move things around now, when you're working with a few sentences instead of thousands of words. Your outline should help you write. If you're decorating it for three weeks because starting feels uncomfortable, it's time to draft a chapter.

TEACH LIKE YOU'RE TALKING TO A REAL PERSON

You already know how to explain things to people. Use that ability. Picture one reader asking a question across the table and write the answer you would give. Your language can be professional and still sound human. Nobody needs you to become a different person because you're writing a book. They need access to the thinking that makes your work useful.

NOBODY NEEDS YOU TO BECOME A DIFFERENT PERSON BECAUSE YOU'RE WRITING A BOOK.

If writing feels awkward, try speaking through one section aloud and recording yourself. You can use a transcript as rough material, then shape it into readable paragraphs. Spoken explanations often wander or repeat themselves, so editing still matters. But talking can help you recover examples and phrases that disappear when you suddenly feel required to sound like an author.

Use stories with a purpose. An example should help the reader understand the lesson, recognize a situation, or see how an action works. You don't need every detail of the person's life. Explain the starting problem, what happened, and what the reader should notice. For client stories, protect confidentiality and obtain permission where needed. Label invented scenarios clearly rather than presenting them as actual results.

Keep checking how much background your reader has. A term you use every day may need a short explanation. A familiar exercise may need instructions that you normally deliver verbally. Imagine someone reading alone after a long day, with nobody available to answer questions. What would help them understand the point without rereading the paragraph three times?

A useful chapter rhythm is to introduce the situation, explain the idea, demonstrate it, and give the reader a way to apply it. You can vary that rhythm, but it gives you somewhere to start. Read sections aloud as you revise. If a sentence sounds unnatural coming out of your mouth, rewrite it in language you'd actually use.

GIVE READERS SOMETHING TO DO

You know how I feel about reading and nodding. It's comfortable. It can even feel productive. But if your book promises to help someone develop a skill or change an approach, give them opportunities to practice. An activity helps readers connect your teaching to their circumstances. It also shows whether they've understood enough to use what you've explained.

Match the exercise to the chapter's purpose. If you're teaching someone to separate observation from assumption, ask them to rewrite a judgment as a description of behavior. If you're teaching

planning, help them produce a plan. Avoid adding reflection questions simply because the chapter needs an activity. Decide what useful work the reader should accomplish, then design the instructions around it.

Make the task manageable. Tell readers what they need, what to do, and what they should have when they're finished. Show a short example if the instruction could be interpreted several ways. Someone should be able to complete the exercise without booking a call to ask what you meant. Save complicated assignments for moments when the reader has enough preparation.

Include a way to review the result. In a feedback exercise, readers could check whether they named a specific behavior and explained the expected change. Those checks make the activity more useful than filling a page and moving on. Optional worksheets can provide extra space, but the instructions inside the book should still make sense if someone doesn't download anything.

GET THE DRAFT DONE, THEN MAKE IT BETTER

Now you need a writing schedule that fits your life. I wrote in the pockets of time I could find. Your available time may look different, and that's fine. Choose sessions you can realistically protect. A clear assignment helps: "Draft the example for Chapter 2" is easier to begin than "Work on my book." Decide the task before the session starts.

Before finishing each session, leave yourself a note about where to resume. Write the next question you want to answer or the example you need. Tomorrow, you'll have an easier way back into your own thinking.

Use your outline to keep moving. If you can't remember a detail or need to verify a claim, leave a visible note and continue with another part. Come back and resolve every note before publication. You don't need to stop a productive session to research something unrelated to the paragraph you're drafting. Keep a separate list so those questions don't disappear.

Try to complete a rough version before repeatedly polishing the opening. You can spend hours improving a chapter that later needs to move or be cut. Once the draft exists, review the larger structure first. Does it deliver the promise? Is the order useful? Are there gaps, unnecessary repetition, or sections that belong in another book? Fix those before fussing over individual sentences.

Then get feedback and editing support appropriate to the manuscript. Someone reviewing structure can help with progression and missing explanations. Copyediting addresses sentence-level clarity and consistency; proofreading catches remaining errors in the prepared pages. The work may reveal problems you missed. That's useful. Give yourself time to revise, check facts and permissions, and review the final layout before publishing.

ACTIVITY

BUILD YOUR CHAPTER MAP AND WRITING SCHEDULE

Open your workbook and create an entry for each planned chapter. Include the chapter's purpose, its main teaching points, an example, an activity, and the result readers should have afterward. Compare the entries with your method map. Look for missing steps and repeated material before deciding that you need another chapter.

Next, choose your writing sessions for the coming week. Assign one concrete task to each session and decide what a finished session will produce. Leave room for interruptions. If you miss a session, adjust the plan and return to it. Spending the next three days feeling guilty won't add anything to the manuscript.

Complete these prompts before you close the workbook:

- My reader's main takeaway from each chapter will be:
- The chapter I will draft first is:
- My next three writing sessions are:
- The task for each session is:

- The feedback or editing support I need is:
- The date I will review my progress is:

WORKSHEET

EXPERT BOOK CHAPTER TEMPLATE

Open your *Expert Book Chapter Template* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to organize the opening, explanation, example, and activity for one chapter. Start with a section you understand well and build from there. You can adjust the structure whenever the material needs a different approach.

Your first draft gives you something to improve. Put the knowledge on the page, follow the reader's progress, and keep showing up for the next session. In the next chapter, we'll examine the evidence behind your teaching so readers can understand why your approach deserves their trust.

8

When I tell you that I signed six corporate clients in the first month after publishing, I understand why that gets your attention. It got mine, too. I had lost my job, I was the only breadwinner, and I had children to feed. Those opportunities mattered. But if all I gave you was the number, you would miss the experience, decisions, and work surrounding it.

I had leadership training behind me. I sent my book ahead of meetings, gave copies away, and used it to introduce my approach. People could read how I worked before we spoke. That context helps you understand my story. It also keeps one person's experience from becoming an expectation that every author will get the same outcome simply by publishing.

We've reached O in the P.R.O.V.E. Method: Offer the Evidence. You've identified a problem and organized the method you teach. Now you need to help readers understand why your approach deserves consideration. Your stories, examples, and results can support that understanding when you present them carefully. Let's look at what you have, what it actually demonstrates, and how to make it useful.

YOUR STORY OPENS THE DOOR

Your story helps readers understand why this subject matters to you. In my introduction, I shared the return to Canada, the children, the commuting, and the decision to build my business. Those details explain the circumstances behind my choices. They also give you a chance to recognize something familiar, whether that's exhaustion, uncertainty, or wanting more freedom in your working life.

You don't need a dramatic life story to connect with readers. Perhaps you noticed the same difficulty across teams you trained. Maybe you struggled with something before learning how to handle it. Choose an experience that explains your relationship with the problem. You don't have to share every personal detail to make that relationship clear.

Keep asking what the reader gains from the story. Does it explain why you developed the approach? Does it show a mistake they can learn from? Does it make an unfamiliar situation easier to understand? Include enough context to serve that purpose, then return to the teaching. Your reader came for help, and your experience should help them find it.

YOUR READER CAME FOR HELP, AND YOUR EXPERIENCE SHOULD HELP THEM FIND IT.

Be precise about what your story supports. Having overcome a challenge can give you valuable insight, but your experience alone doesn't establish that a process works for everyone. Explain what you learned and where your approach has developed since then. You can sound confident while acknowledging the limits of what one person's experience can tell another.

SHOW WHAT CHANGED FOR YOUR CLIENTS

A useful case study lets readers see your method at work. Start with the client's situation, explain what you did together, and describe

the change you observed. Include the details that make the sequence understandable. “She became more confident” leaves plenty of questions. What was she struggling to do before? What did she practice? What became different afterward?

Imagine a fictional manager who avoids giving feedback because she fears upsetting her team. During preparation, she learns to describe specific behavior and state expectations clearly. She practices her opening, holds the conversation, and schedules a follow-up. This example shows how the steps fit together. Because it’s invented, it illustrates the process; it doesn’t demonstrate an actual client result.

For a real case study, go back to your records instead of relying only on memory. Review the starting goal, the work completed, the timeframe, and any documented outcome. If you interview the client, ask what changed and what else contributed. Their perspective may add something you missed or challenge the neat version you were about to write.

Be clear about permission before publishing identifiable details. Let the person review how their experience and words will appear, and address any confidentiality commitments. Changing a name may still leave somebody recognizable through their role or circumstances. If you combine experiences into a composite, label it accordingly. Your reader should understand what kind of example they’re reading.

Choose cases relevant to your intended reader. A story about a global executive may be impressive, but a new manager might struggle to see the connection. Similar circumstances can help readers recognize how your teaching applies. You don’t need the biggest organization or the most dramatic transformation in every example. A clearly explained change can teach a great deal.

PUT YOUR RESULTS IN CONTEXT

Numbers can make a result easier to understand, provided you explain them. If you say something improved by fifty percent, tell readers what was measured and where it started. Moving from two

completed tasks to three is different from the picture someone may imagine. Include the timeframe and the source of the measurement so the claim has something solid underneath it.

Also distinguish between what a client reported and what you measured directly. "The client reported feeling better prepared" describes a different kind of evidence from an independently tracked change in performance. Both can be informative. Problems arise when you make one sound like the other or use a small observation to support a much larger promise.

Watch the temptation to give your method credit for everything. A client's progress may also reflect practice, a supportive manager, other training, or changes in their situation. You can explain the role your work played without pretending those factors disappeared. Ask what the available information reasonably supports, and write that claim rather than the most exciting version of it.

My results belong to my story. You can learn from the actions I describe without treating the same numbers as a forecast for your business. Apply that distinction to your own examples. Present the outcome alongside the starting circumstances and the effort involved. Readers should be able to assess the relevance without assuming that one strong result represents everyone's experience.

Keep a record behind each claim. Save the source, date, wording, and relevant context in your evidence bank. Mark anything you still need to verify. This will make editing easier and help you respond if someone asks where a statement came from.

USE EXAMPLES WHEN YOU'RE STILL BUILDING YOUR TRACK RECORD

Maybe you're reading this and thinking, "I don't have years of client results." Start with what you can honestly show. You may have teaching experience, completed projects, or a clear demonstration of how your process works. Explain your role accurately. Work completed as part of a team can support your experience without being presented as something you achieved alone.

You can walk readers through a worked example. Show a confusing feedback statement, explain what's unclear, and revise it

using your method. Readers can inspect the reasoning themselves. Label the example as illustrative and avoid attaching invented outcomes to it. A demonstration can make your teaching concrete even when you don't yet have a case study.

Relevant research can also support parts of your explanation. Read the source where possible and check what was studied, with whom, and under what conditions. Research supporting one principle doesn't automatically validate your entire branded method. Explain the connection honestly and provide a reference readers can follow. Don't turn somebody else's findings into a claim they never made.

As you build experience, collect feedback and track useful measures with participants' knowledge. Ask specific questions about what they applied, what helped, and what remained difficult. Include less successful experiences in your own review. They can show where your instructions need work. Building evidence should improve your teaching as well as give you material for the book.

ACTIVITY

BUILD YOUR EVIDENCE BANK

Create a document or spreadsheet with one entry for each story, result, example, or research source you might use. Start with three candidates connected to your book's main promise. For each entry, answer these questions:

- What teaching point does this support?
- Is it a personal experience, client case, demonstration, or research finding?
- What happened, and over what timeframe?
- What records or sources support the details?
- What other factors or limitations should readers understand?
- What permission, verification, or clarification is still needed?

Review each entry before adding it to the manuscript. Separate material that's ready from material that needs checking. If a claim feels bigger than the information supporting it, narrow the claim. Look for gaps across your chapters, too. The goal is a useful collection of evidence distributed where it helps the reader understand your teaching.

WORKSHEET

CASE STUDY INTERVIEW AND PERMISSION TEMPLATES

Open your *Case Study Interview and Permission Templates* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use the interview questions to explore the starting problem, the work, and the outcome. Adapt the permission template to the situation and any existing confidentiality commitments. Keep the approved wording with your evidence notes.

You already know the value of your experience. Now you're helping readers examine it for themselves. Choose clear examples, explain results honestly, and give credit where it belongs. In the next chapter, we'll help readers experience your teaching and use their feedback to strengthen the book.

CHAPTER 9

When all the training moved online, I wanted people to do more than sit through another boring Zoom session. I took courses, polished my skills, and created activities that made the experience more engaging. I wanted leaders to send their employees to me because the training was useful. Having something to say mattered. Helping people work with it mattered, too.

Your book needs that same attention. You can explain your method beautifully and include strong evidence, but your reader still needs to apply the teaching. Can they follow the instructions without you? Do the examples answer their questions? Where do they get lost? We're still working through O in P.R.O.V.E.: Offer the Evidence. This time, we're giving readers an opportunity to experience your expertise and tell you what needs improvement.

GIVE THEM A USEFUL WIN INSIDE THE BOOK

Think about what your reader could accomplish early in the book. Something small, relevant, and useful enough to make them think, "Okay, I can work with this." They might identify the real issue behind a difficult conversation, clarify a decision, or complete a

preparation exercise. Choose progress that supports the larger promise instead of adding an easy activity just to keep them busy.

For our feedback example, you could help a manager rewrite "My employee has a bad attitude" into a description of specific behavior. That doesn't resolve the whole situation. It gives the manager a clearer starting point for addressing it. The reader can see the difference between the original statement and the revised one, which makes the teaching easier to evaluate.

Explain why the task matters before asking someone to complete it. Show an example, give clear instructions, and describe what a useful result looks like. Then connect that result to the next step. Your reader should understand how the exercise contributes to the method rather than wondering why they've stopped reading to fill in another blank.

Check what you're asking people to access. If an activity requires a worksheet, make it easy to find and explain how to proceed without it where possible. A broken link or unclear instruction can interrupt a willing reader. You worked hard to get them interested. Make the experience straightforward enough that they can stay focused on learning.

TEST YOUR TEACHING WITH EARLY READERS

An early reader helps you see the manuscript through someone else's eyes. Choose people who resemble your intended audience and can give thoughtful feedback. A knowledgeable colleague may catch technical problems, while somebody facing the actual challenge can tell you whether the explanation helps. Different readers can contribute different perspectives, provided you're clear about what you're asking each person to assess.

Start with a small group you can manage. You don't need fifty opinions arriving the night before publication. You need enough relevant feedback to identify confusing instructions, missing explanations, and repeated questions. Give readers a workable deadline and leave yourself time afterward to revise. Asking for feedback means making room to do something with it.

> **YOU DON'T NEED FIFTY OPINIONS ARRIVING THE NIGHT BEFORE PUBLICATION.**

Send a readable draft with clear instructions. Explain whether you want feedback on the whole manuscript or a particular chapter. If your main concern is the method, ask them to try an exercise and describe where they hesitated. If you're testing the opening, ask what they expect the book to deliver after reading it. Specific requests usually produce more useful responses.

Make it comfortable to tell you something isn't working. You can say, "Please mark any place where you need an example or aren't sure what to do." That gives readers permission to be direct. Don't make them feel responsible for protecting your feelings. They're helping you discover problems while those problems are still relatively easy to fix.

Try watching a willing reader work through one exercise without stepping in. Ask them to say what they think each instruction means. You'll notice where they pause, reread, or make an assumption you didn't intend. Resist the urge to rescue the activity with a quick explanation. Write down what you would have said, then consider whether that explanation belongs on the page. This small test can show you what your presence usually adds when you teach the material in person.

USE FEEDBACK TO STRENGTHEN THE MANUSCRIPT

Reading criticism of your own work can be uncomfortable. You spent hours on a chapter, and someone says they didn't understand the point. Take a breath before explaining why they should have understood it. Ask where they lost the thread. Their response can reveal something useful even when you disagree with the change they suggest.

Separate observations from proposed solutions. "I didn't know how to complete this exercise" identifies a problem. "You should remove the exercise" is one possible solution. You might instead add an example, clarify the instructions, or teach a missing concept earlier. Your reader can show you where the experience breaks down without necessarily knowing the best way to repair it.

Look for patterns across responses, but don't decide everything by majority vote. Several readers missing the same point deserves attention. So does one reader identifying a factual error or a serious gap. Personal preferences about tone or favorite examples may need less weight. Bring each decision back to your intended reader, the chapter's purpose, and the promise you're making.

Keep a revision list with the issue, the proposed change, and your decision. Address structural problems before polishing sentences that might disappear. Once you've revised a difficult section, ask someone to try it again. You want to know whether the change helped. A longer explanation isn't automatically a clearer explanation, and extra pages can create fresh confusion.

ASK FOR HONEST REVIEWS AND ENDORSEMENTS

Private manuscript feedback, public customer reviews, and endorsements serve different purposes. Feedback helps you improve the book. A customer review shares a reader's assessment with potential buyers. An endorsement is a recommendation you have permission to use in your book or marketing. Decide which you're requesting, and make that request clear. Agreeing to read a draft doesn't obligate someone to promote it.

For customer reviews, invite an honest opinion without asking for a particular rating or supplying praise to paste. A simple request might say, "If you've read the book and would like to share your experience, an honest review can help other readers decide whether it's right for them." Give people the choice. Their review belongs to them.

Amazon's KDP guidance allows free or discounted book copies when you don't require a review or try to influence it. It says other

compensation, including gift cards, invalidates reviews. Keep your workbook, bonuses, and other giveaways separate from review requests. Nobody should have to post a review to receive a resource you've promised them. Check the current rules before organizing your outreach.

For endorsements, approach people whose relevant experience helps them assess the book. Explain the audience, provide the manuscript, and give them time to read. Ask whether they'd be willing to offer a brief recommendation if they feel comfortable doing so. Confirm the exact wording, attribution, and permitted uses before publishing it. A person's name deserves the same care as their words.

Keep requests respectful and manageable. One courteous reminder can be reasonable; repeated pressure can damage the relationship. Some readers won't respond, and some won't recommend the book. That's part of asking for independent opinions. Use what you learn to improve the work, and remember that a meaningful recommendation starts with someone having something genuine to recommend.

ACTIVITY

CREATE YOUR EARLY READER PLAN

Open your workbook and identify a small group of potential early readers. Note why each person is relevant and what feedback they could provide. Choose a version of the manuscript to share, a response deadline, and a period for revisions. Then prepare these questions:

- What did you expect the book to help you do?
- Which explanation or example helped most?
- Where did you feel confused or need more detail?
- Which activity did you try, and what happened?
- What felt repetitive or unnecessary?
- What question remained unanswered when you finished?

Create a separate list for potential endorsement requests and voluntary review outreach. Record what each person has agreed to do so you don't confuse manuscript feedback with public support. Start with the feedback round. Improving the reader's experience now will give you a stronger book to introduce later.

WORKSHEET

FEEDBACK FORM AND REVIEW REQUEST TEMPLATES

Open your *Feedback Form and Review Request Templates* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Adapt them to your audience, keep the requests clear, and check applicable platform rules before sending. Use the feedback form to collect observations you can act on rather than general compliments.

Your readers don't need every sentence to impress them. They need a book that helps them understand and do something useful. Give them that experience, listen when something needs work, and keep improving. Next, we'll move into V: Value Your Expertise and define the paid help interested readers can hire you to provide.

10

When people began reaching out after reading my book, I had something to offer them. I could teach leadership. I had years of experience doing it, and the book helped people understand my approach before we spoke. That connection mattered. When someone asked about working together, we could talk about their needs and the training that might help.

Now imagine that happening to you. A reader finishes your book and says, "I need help applying this. What do you offer?" You don't want your answer to become a tour of every skill you've ever developed. You want to understand their situation and explain a relevant way forward. That's what we're building in this chapter: a paid offer you can describe clearly and deliver well.

CONNECT YOUR BOOK TO A PAID OFFER

We've reached V in the P.R.O.V.E. Method: Value Your Expertise. Your book teaches readers something useful. Your paid offer gives suitable people additional help applying that knowledge in their circumstances. Some readers will work independently and never contact you. Wonderful. Others may need feedback, guidance,

practice, or implementation support. Think carefully about what you can add to their experience.

Return to the problem your book addresses. Where might a reader need personal attention? Perhaps they understand how to prepare a difficult conversation but want to rehearse it with someone. Maybe a company wants managers practicing together using workplace scenarios. Those needs suggest different offers. Start with the support required rather than deciding you need a course because everybody seems to have one.

Describe one offer before creating a menu of options. Who is it for? What will you help them accomplish? How will you work together? What will they have by the end? If you struggle to answer, simplify the offer. A prospective client shouldn't need a second meeting just to understand what you were proposing in the first.

You can use the same method in your book and your paid work. The additional value might come from tailoring the process, observing practice, reviewing decisions, or helping someone implement a plan. Explain that contribution. Your book should already be useful, and your paid support should have a clear purpose beyond providing information you deliberately left out.

CHOOSE HOW YOU'LL DELIVER THE HELP

Choose a format that suits both the client's needs and your strengths. Coaching may fit someone who needs guided reflection and support taking action. Consulting may involve assessing a situation and recommending solutions. Training gives people structured instruction and practice. A workshop can help a group produce something specific together. Explain the actual work, because labels alone can mean different things.

Think about the leadership example we've been using. A new manager might benefit from individual sessions to prepare and rehearse feedback. A company might need a workshop for twelve managers, followed by a practice session. Another organization might want help developing its feedback process. The topic

connects them, but the work, preparation, and responsibilities will differ.

Consider what the client can realistically do between sessions. If progress depends on practicing a skill, give them time and instructions for practice. If the work requires documents or input from colleagues, identify that early. A delivery schedule should support the outcome. Six calls on a calendar won't create progress simply because you've packaged them neatly.

Also consider the business you want to run. I wanted to work from home, wherever that happened to be. Your delivery choices affect your schedule, travel, preparation, and energy. Be honest about what you can sustain. An offer that sounds impressive but requires you to be available constantly can become difficult to deliver as soon as people start buying.

BE HONEST ABOUT WHAT YOU CAN SUSTAIN. ”

DEFINE THE OUTCOME AND THE BOUNDARIES

Write the intended outcome in language the client understands. "Leadership transformation" sounds ambitious, but what will you work on? "Prepare and practice three difficult workplace conversations" gives everyone a clearer picture. You can explain the broader benefit while staying specific about the work. Choose an outcome you can support without guaranteeing another person's behavior or circumstances.

Then define what's included. Specify the number and length of sessions, the materials provided, any review work, and the form of support between meetings. If you answer questions by email, explain the response window and any limits. You don't need to sound unfriendly. Clear expectations help clients use the service and help you deliver what you've promised.

Identify what's outside the offer, too. Suppose you're teaching feedback skills. Reviewing an entire company's performance

management system may be a separate project. Without that distinction, additional requests can quietly expand the work. Explain how changes will be discussed and agreed upon before you begin them. Everyone should know when a new request affects the scope, schedule, or price.

Clarify what the client contributes. They may need to attend sessions, prepare examples, practice, or provide timely information. Discuss those responsibilities before they commit. You can bring your expertise and deliver the agreed support, but you can't do another person's participation for them. Your offer should make that shared responsibility understandable from the beginning.

Before presenting the offer widely, walk through the experience from the client's side. What happens after they agree? How do they prepare for the first session? When do they receive materials, and how will you review progress together? Write down those practical details. An attractive description gets someone's attention; a thoughtful delivery experience helps you fulfill the agreement and gives the client confidence in the work ahead.

PRICE THE WORK SO YOU CAN DELIVER IT WELL

Putting a price on your expertise can feel personal. You've spent years learning, and now you're trying to express the value in a number. Start by understanding the work you're selling. Consider preparation, delivery, follow-up, administration, and any direct expenses. Include time that clients don't see. Those hours still belong to your business and need room in your planning.

For an illustrative example, imagine a workshop involving two hours of delivery, three hours of preparation, and one hour of coordination and follow-up. That's six hours before considering other business responsibilities or expenses. If you price it as though you're only working during the workshop, you're overlooking much of the effort. Use realistic estimates and update them after delivery.

Costs help you understand what's sustainable, but they don't explain the entire value to a client. Consider the problem, the usefulness of the outcome, the degree of customization, and the

alternatives available. Ask prospective clients how they evaluate this kind of support. Research comparable offers while noticing differences in audience, experience, scope, and delivery. A competitor's number without context won't tell you yours.

You don't need to apologize when stating a considered price. Explain the offer and let the client assess it. If their budget doesn't fit, you can explore a smaller scope where appropriate. Be deliberate about discounts. Reducing the price while leaving every commitment untouched may create an engagement you resent or struggle to deliver. Keep the agreement workable for both sides.

Check your capacity as well as your price. How many engagements can you handle while maintaining quality and running the rest of your business? A crowded calendar can leave little time for promotion, development, or rest. Track the actual effort after each engagement. Use that information, alongside client feedback and outcomes, to improve the offer and its pricing.

ACTIVITY

BUILD YOUR PAID OFFER

Open your workbook and design one offer connected to your book. Keep it focused enough that you can explain it in a short conversation. Answer these questions before worrying about a clever name or a polished sales page:

- Who is this offer for, and when would they need it?
- What outcome will we work toward?
- What format and timeline fit that work?
- What sessions, materials, and support are included?
- What is excluded, and what must the client contribute?
- What preparation, delivery time, and expenses should I account for?
- What price am I proposing, and why is it workable?
- How many clients can I support at once?

Write a short description using your answers. Then discuss it with someone who understands the intended audience. Ask them to explain what they think they're buying, what remains unclear, and what information they would need before deciding. Listen without defending every detail. Revise confusing language and check that you can deliver each commitment you've included.

WORKSHEET

OFFER AND PRICING PLANNER

Open your *Offer and Pricing Planner* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to map your scope, estimate the work, and compare possible delivery options. Choose one version to develop first. You can expand later, once you understand what clients need and what delivery actually requires.

Your book gives readers a way to know your thinking. Your offer explains how you can help them take the next step with support. Put care into both. In the next chapter, we'll make that next step easy to find, so an interested reader doesn't have to guess how to continue with you.

11TH

I sent my book ahead of meetings and gave copies away at events because I wanted people to understand my work. Sometimes they left with an extra copy for a friend. I loved knowing that my ideas could travel into rooms where I wasn't present. But once somebody became interested, they still needed a way to reach me and explore what we could do together.

Your reader needs that same connection. They may finish a chapter thinking, "This is exactly what I need help with." Don't make them investigate three websites to find out whether you offer that help. In Chapter 10, you defined your paid offer. Now we'll create a clear path between your teaching and the next step, while we're still working through V: Value Your Expertise.

INVITE YOUR READER RIGHT AT THE BEGINNING

Start by deciding what you want an interested reader to do. Download a resource? Watch one of your videos? Book a call with you? Then put that invitation right at the beginning of your book, and ask people to leave their name and email address. Don't save it

for the closing pages. Most people never read past Chapter 3, so an invitation at the back is one most readers never see.

This matters for another reason. The beginning of your book shows up in the sample on Amazon. That means people don't even need to buy your book before they can get access to your worksheets, watch one of your videos, or book a call with you. It's a very smart way of promoting your programs and promoting yourself. So invite people early, and give each invitation a purpose so it's easy to say yes.

Explain what they will receive and how it helps. "Visit my website" leaves plenty of guessing. "Download the conversation planner to prepare the opening, examples, and follow-up for your next feedback meeting" tells them why the click might be worthwhile. Use straightforward language that connects the resource to the work they've just completed.

Then keep inviting as the book goes on. An exercise can point to a supporting worksheet, and the closing pages can explain your services again for the readers who make it there. Readers should still receive the teaching they paid for inside the book. The invitation extends a useful experience and gives people enough information to decide whether they want to continue with you.

CREATE A GIVEAWAY PEOPLE WILL ACTUALLY USE

You know those downloads you save with every intention of opening them? Somewhere on your computer, they're probably having a meeting without you. Please don't create another enormous resource simply because more pages feel generous. Choose something your reader can use for a specific task. A practical checklist may be more useful than another fifty pages of explanations.

A PRACTICAL CHECKLIST MAY BE MORE USEFUL THAN ANOTHER FIFTY PAGES OF EXPLANATIONS.

Look at the point where readers might need support applying your method. Could a template help them organize their thoughts? Would a short demonstration clarify a difficult step? Could a set of questions help them prepare for a conversation? The resource should have a clear job. You should be able to explain its usefulness in one or two sentences.

For our feedback example, a planner might ask the reader to record observable behavior, describe its impact, and identify the expected change. Include a completed example and brief instructions. Someone opening the resource a week after reading the chapter should still understand what to do. Make the file easy to read, complete, and find again.

Connect the giveaway to your paid work without turning every page into a sales pitch. The planner can help someone prepare independently, while a short closing note explains that you offer rehearsal and feedback support. That connection is understandable. Readers get something useful, and those who need more help can see where your service fits.

SET UP YOUR LINKS, QR CODES, AND WELCOME EMAILS

Create a dedicated page for the resource so readers arrive somewhere specific. Repeat the resource's name, explain what it does, and make the next action obvious. A person following a link from your book shouldn't wonder whether they've landed in the wrong place. Keep the page focused on delivering what you promised rather than introducing every part of your business.

If you ask for an email address, explain what the reader is signing up to receive. Make any ongoing messages clear and give subscribers an easy way to stop them. Follow the requirements that apply to your audience and service. You can build a useful relationship while being transparent about how you'll communicate.

A QR code can make access convenient for someone holding a printed book. Include a readable web address alongside it so there is another route. For digital editions, use a working link where

permitted by the publishing platform. Choose an address you can maintain, ideally under a domain you control, so you can manage the destination as your resources change.

Test the whole experience yourself, then ask somebody unfamiliar with the setup to try it. Scan the printed code, open the link on a phone, complete the form, and download the resource. Check that the text is readable and the file works. A process can appear finished on your computer and still confuse somebody encountering it for the first time.

Your first email should deliver the promised resource or make access unmistakably clear. Welcome the reader, remind them how they found you, and suggest one useful action. A later message might explain a common obstacle or offer an example. Keep each message focused. You don't need to tell your entire life story before letting someone open the worksheet.

Decide how often you'll write and what ongoing value you can provide. Set expectations you can maintain. Some messages can teach, and others can explain a relevant offer. Avoid making every email sound like an emergency. People should understand why they're hearing from you and have enough information to choose whether your help is right for them.

Keep a simple record of every address printed in your book and schedule occasional checks. If you replace a resource or change services, update the destination so earlier readers still find something relevant. Printed copies may circulate for years. That person opening your book long after launch deserves a working invitation, even if your website has changed since you first published.

INVITE THE RIGHT PEOPLE INTO A CONVERSATION

When someone is ready to explore your services, explain who the offer is for and what the conversation will cover. You might say that you'll discuss their situation, the support they're seeking, and whether your program fits. Include practical details such as the

meeting length and whether there is a charge. Nobody should have to guess what they're booking.

Use a short set of questions to prepare. Ask what they want help with, what they've tried, and what they're hoping to change. Only request information you need at this stage. A long questionnaire can feel like homework before the person even knows whether you can help. Keep the process proportionate to the service you're discussing.

During the conversation, listen before presenting the offer. The fact that somebody enjoyed your book doesn't automatically make them a suitable client. They may need a different type of support, a different timeline, or something outside your expertise. Use what they share to assess fit. You want an agreement you can deliver well and they can participate in meaningfully.

If there is a fit, explain the work, responsibilities, price, and next steps clearly. Give them space to ask questions and decide. If they aren't ready, agree on an appropriate follow-up rather than chasing them indefinitely. Your book began a relationship through useful teaching. Let your conversations continue with that same clarity and respect.

ACTIVITY

MAP YOUR READER-TO-CLIENT JOURNEY

Open your workbook and trace the route from one chapter to your paid offer. Keep it simple enough that you can build and test it before publication. Complete these prompts:

- The chapter that introduces the next step is:
- The resource I will offer is:
- It helps my reader complete this task:
- The invitation inside the book will say:
- The page address and access method will be:
- My first email will deliver:

- My next useful message will explain:
- Readers seeking paid support can:
- I will test the complete experience on:

Read the sequence aloud as if you were describing it to a reader. Look for missing information, unnecessary steps, or promises you haven't fulfilled. Build the essential pieces first, then ask someone to follow the entire route. Record where they hesitate and fix those points before adding more features.

WORKSHEET

BOOK INVITATION AND WELCOME EMAIL TEMPLATES

Open your *Book Invitation and Welcome Email Templates* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Adapt the wording to your resource, audience, and voice. Include the actual instructions readers need, and check every destination before using the templates in your book or emails.

You don't need a complicated system to begin. You need a useful next step, a reliable way to deliver it, and a clear invitation for people who want additional help. In the next chapter, we'll move into E: Engage Your Future Clients and prepare your book for launch.

12

The day my book went live was also the day I lost my corporate job. I had plenty to think about, believe me. But the book was finally out in the world, and I could begin putting it into people's hands. You've heard what happened afterward. Now let's focus on the preparation that gives your own book a solid starting point.

We've reached E in the P.R.O.V.E. Method: Engage Your Future Clients. You have something to teach, a manuscript you've worked to improve, and a way for interested readers to continue with you. Before making a big announcement, make sure the book is ready to receive that attention. Your reader's experience begins with the listing and continues through every page, exercise, and invitation.

CHOOSE YOUR FORMATS AND PREPARE YOUR FILES

Choose formats based on how people will use the book. A paperback can work well for events, gifts, and readers who like making notes. An ebook offers another reading option. You can add other formats as your plans develop, but each requires preparation and checking.

Start with editions you can produce properly instead of creating extra work simply because an option exists.

For print, decide the book's dimensions, paper, ink, and interior layout before finalizing the cover. Those choices affect the finished object and its production cost. Give exercises enough room, keep text comfortable to read, and check whether diagrams remain understandable at the intended size. Your reader should be able to use the book without fighting the design.

Prepare the digital edition for reading on different screen sizes. Don't assume a file that looks good as printed pages will automatically work beautifully as an ebook. Check headings, navigation, images, and links in the appropriate preview tools. If you're hiring a formatter, explain which editions you need and ask for editable source files alongside the finished uploads.

Use the current KDP requirements for each format and keep your files organized. Your manuscript and cover must match the details entered during setup, including the title, subtitle, and author name. Upload the correct versions, then inspect them in the previewer. Amazon provides guidance for uploading and previewing both print and digital content.

SET UP YOUR AMAZON BOOK LISTING

Open your publishing account early enough to complete the required account, payment, and tax information before your planned release. Follow the instructions shown for your circumstances. Keep access to the account and your publishing records under your control, even when someone helps with production. You should know where your book lives and how to manage it.

Bring together the title, subtitle, description, categories, and keyword research you've already developed. This is where those earlier decisions become part of the actual listing. Read everything again before entering it. Look for consistent spelling and a clear match between the promise on the cover and the description. You're introducing one book, so the pieces should agree.

Review identifiers, publishing rights, and distribution choices carefully during setup. Use the platform's current guidance to understand the options that apply to your edition. If you're considering an optional program, read its conditions before enrolling. A choice involving exclusivity, for example, needs to fit any plans you have to distribute the same content elsewhere.

Set the price with the edition's costs and your plans in mind. Review the estimated royalty shown during setup instead of assuming the cover price is what you'll receive. Think about comparable books, the value of the content, and how you expect readers to buy. If you're planning a temporary launch price, record when you'll review it.

Before submitting, confirm that the uploaded files, listing details, and settings are the versions you approved. Some changes are easier to make before publication than afterward. Don't rush through the final screens because you're excited to hit the button. Take the extra time to read what you're confirming and resolve questions while you can still work calmly.

DON'T RUSH THROUGH THE FINAL SCREENS BECAUSE YOU'RE EXCITED TO HIT THE BUTTON.

CHECK THE PROOF BEFORE YOU HIT PUBLISH

Please order a physical proof for your print edition. I know you want to hold the finished book and get moving. That's exactly why this step matters. You're checking the product your reader will experience. Screen previews are useful, but paper can reveal problems with readability, spacing, color, or placement that you didn't notice on a monitor.

KDP proof copies carry a "Not for Resale" marking and are intended for checking. Author copies are copies of your live book available at print cost; allow for applicable shipping and taxes when budgeting. Plan for the appropriate copies at each stage, and don't

build an event around an assumed delivery date. Check the ordering information before committing.

Inspect the cover, spine, back, chapter openings, page numbers, and exercises. Read passages from different sections rather than only admiring the first few pages. Check that images and tables remain legible. Scan every QR code and test every printed address. An invitation that leads nowhere won't become more useful because the cover looks beautiful.

Review the ebook separately. Try different text sizes where supported, navigate through the contents, and follow the links. If a worksheet is difficult to use digitally, explain the available alternative. Ask someone else to check as well. Familiarity makes it surprisingly easy to read what you intended instead of what is actually there.

Keep a corrections list, update the source files, and upload the revised versions. Recheck affected pages and anything the changes might have shifted. Build this time into the schedule. The proof is there to reveal problems, so discovering one means the check was worthwhile. Fix it before asking readers to pay for the finished edition.

BUILD YOUR LAUNCH TEAM AND CALENDAR

Your launch team can be a small group of willing supporters who understand the book and want to help introduce it. Think about colleagues, professional contacts, and people interested in the subject. Ask about specific activities rather than announcing that everyone you know has been recruited. Give them room to choose what they can realistically contribute.

Someone might share an announcement, introduce you to a podcast host, or help organize a teaching event. Prepare a short book description, an approved cover image, and clear information about the intended reader. Make sharing easy without asking people to pretend they've read or endorsed something they haven't. Keep any review invitation voluntary and consistent with the rules discussed earlier.

Keep your launch materials in one folder with filenames you can recognize. Label approved versions clearly, and remove outdated attachments from outgoing messages. Your supporters shouldn't have to guess which cover or description to use.

Work backward from your intended launch period. Allow time for editing, formatting, proofs, corrections, platform review, and delivery of any printed stock. Check KDP's current timelines and the status information in your account. Submitting a book doesn't mean every listing feature becomes available immediately. Leave room for delays before scheduling announcements that depend on a working purchase page.

You can separate publication from your main promotional push. Once the book is available, verify the listing, formats, prices, and links before sending people there. Then coordinate your outreach around confirmed availability. Choose a manageable set of activities you can execute well. You still need energy to answer questions, follow up, and serve the people your launch reaches.

✎ ACTIVITY

COMPLETE YOUR LAUNCH READINESS CHECKLIST

Open your workbook and review the essentials below. Mark each item ready, in progress, or waiting on someone else. Assign a person and deadline to anything unfinished so your launch date reflects the work remaining.

- My chosen formats and production files are approved.
- My account setup and publishing details are complete.
- My cover, title, description, categories, and keywords agree.
- My pricing and distribution choices have been reviewed.
- My physical proof and digital preview have been checked.
- My corrections are reflected in the final uploads.
- My links, QR codes, resources, and emails work.
- My supporters understand their chosen activities.

- My calendar includes review, revision, and delivery time.
- My purchase links will be verified before promotion.

Identify the three unfinished items most likely to affect your schedule and deal with those first. A social post can wait if your print file still needs correction. Review the checklist again before submitting, then once more when the listing is live. Readiness comes from checking the actual experience.

WORKSHEET

BOOK LAUNCH PLANNER

Open your *Book Launch Planner* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to organize deadlines, responsibilities, copies, and promotional activities. Keep the plan realistic enough to follow alongside your existing work and family commitments. You can add opportunities as they arise without losing track of the essentials.

You've done a lot to reach this point. Let yourself appreciate that, then finish the checks that protect the reader's experience. In the next chapter, we'll put your launch into motion and use your teaching to start conversations with people who could benefit from your expertise.

13

I carried boxes of my book in my car. Ready and loaded. If I was going to an event, the books were coming with me, and so was my pen. I wanted people to leave with something they could read, remember, and share. Sometimes they took an extra copy for a friend. That book could introduce my work long after the event was over.

I WANTED PEOPLE TO LEAVE WITH SOMETHING THEY COULD READ, REMEMBER, AND SHARE.

Your launch gives you a reason to begin those introductions. You've prepared the manuscript, checked the listing, and created a next step for interested readers. Now it's time to tell people the book exists and explain why it matters to them. We're continuing E in P.R.O.V.E.: Engage Your Future Clients. Let's put your teaching to work and give suitable readers a reason to pay attention.

GIVE PEOPLE A REASON TO PAY ATTENTION

Announcing "My book is here!" is exciting, and you should enjoy saying it. You worked for this moment. But somebody who doesn't know you may need more information before they care. Tell them who the book helps, what problem it addresses, and what they'll learn. Give your announcement a connection to the reader's life rather than relying entirely on your excitement.

Use the language you collected earlier in the process. If you're helping new managers give feedback, describe the conversation they keep postponing or the uncertainty about what to say. Then explain how the book helps them prepare. You already did the work of understanding this reader. Let that understanding shape the launch messages instead of switching into language you'd never use in conversation.

Prepare several messages around different parts of the same promise. One could share why you wrote the book. Another could demonstrate a useful exercise. A third could answer a question readers often ask. Keep the central purpose consistent while giving people fresh reasons to engage. Repeating the purchase link every day won't show much of the expertise inside.

Include a clear action with each message. If you're inviting people to buy, provide the correct link and identify the available edition. If you're inviting them to a teaching event, explain what they'll learn and how to attend. Avoid burying the next step under several unrelated requests. Someone who's interested should know what to do without sending you a message first.

PUT YOUR EXISTING RELATIONSHIPS TO WORK

Start with people and communities that already have a relevant connection to your work. That could include colleagues, professional associations, event organizers, and contacts who have asked about the subject. Think about why the book might matter to each group. A thoughtful introduction gives them a reason to

consider it without making every relationship feel like a sales opportunity.

Write personally where the relationship warrants it. You might say, "You mentioned that your new managers need help with feedback. I've published a book that addresses that challenge, and I thought it might be useful to your team." Explain the connection and offer an appropriate next step. Don't pretend a mass message is a personal conversation or assume everyone owes you a purchase.

Give your launch supporters the materials and details you promised. Confirm the working links, timing, and activities they've chosen. If someone offered an introduction, provide a short explanation they can forward easily. Thank people for their help, including those who contribute quietly. Supporting a launch takes time, and a clear request makes that contribution easier.

Consider where giving a copy makes sense. I used books before meetings and at events because I wanted people to experience my ideas. You can make similar choices with a budget and purpose. Record who receives a copy and any agreed follow-up. A gift doesn't create an obligation to buy your services, but it can open a useful conversation.

TEACH YOUR WAY INTO NEW OPPORTUNITIES

You don't have to wait for somebody to invite you onto a stage before sharing what you know. A focused online session, a discussion within a professional group, or an interview can introduce your approach. Choose opportunities that reach the audience your book serves. A smaller gathering of suitable readers can be more relevant than a large audience with little connection to your subject.

Build a session around one problem and one useful takeaway. For the feedback example, you might teach participants how to replace a vague judgment with a specific observation. Explain the distinction, demonstrate it, and let them practice. That gives people a taste of your teaching and a result they can use. You don't need to summarize the entire book in twenty minutes.

Introduce the book naturally as a resource for continuing the work. Explain what it covers and where people can find it. If you offer additional support, briefly describe who it's for and how to learn more. Keep the teaching valuable on its own. People should leave having learned something, whether they buy the book immediately, later, or never.

When approaching a podcast host or event organizer, lead with a topic their audience would find useful. Mention the book as relevant context and explain the conversation or session you could contribute. Include enough information about your experience to support the proposal. Make it easy for them to assess fit rather than asking them to invent a topic for you.

Practice your key explanation and prepare for likely questions. Check the meeting technology, confirm the format, and clarify any arrangements with the host. Afterward, note which questions attracted interest. Those questions can guide future content and help you understand what readers need next. Your launch becomes more useful when you listen as well as speak.

FOLLOW UP WITH PEOPLE WHO RAISE THEIR HANDS

Leave room in your calendar for replies. It's easy to schedule announcements and forget that interested people may respond with questions. Answer promptly within a routine you can sustain. If someone asks where to buy the book, help them find it. If they describe a problem, understand what they're asking before directing them toward a service.

Match the next step to the interest expressed. A person requesting a worksheet hasn't necessarily asked for a consultation. Someone asking about team training may need a conversation about scope and timing. Keep track of what each person requested and what you agreed to send. Thoughtful follow-up begins with remembering the actual conversation.

For a potential client, use the process you developed in Chapter 11. Ask about their situation, explore whether your support fits, and explain the offer clearly where appropriate. Don't assume

enthusiasm about the book means they're ready to hire you. They may be gathering information or recommending it to someone else. Give them space to make that distinction.

Review what happened during the launch instead of judging everything by the busiest day. Look at book sales, resource requests, relevant replies, invitations, and inquiries. Ask new contacts how they found you. These observations won't explain every purchase or opportunity, but they can help you choose where to focus your next round of effort.

Keep a simple launch log with the activity, audience, time spent, and response. If a workshop produces thoughtful questions but a post receives little interest, note that without declaring one channel permanently useless. Different activities may need different amounts of time to develop. You're collecting clues about where your teaching connects, so your next decision can draw on experience rather than guesswork alone.

ACTIVITY

BUILD YOUR LAUNCH WEEK ACTION PLAN

Open your workbook and choose a manageable set of activities for launch week. Identify your main audience, your central message, and the action you want interested people to take. Then assign a day, responsible person, and required materials to each activity.

- **Opening announcement:** Who will receive it, and what will it say?
- **Teaching opportunity:** What will I help people understand or practice?
- **Personal outreach:** Which relevant contacts will I approach individually?
- **Supporter coordination:** What information does my launch team need?
- **Follow-up time:** When will I answer questions and deliver promised resources?

- **Results review:** What will I record, and when will I assess it?

Check the plan against your capacity. Include existing client work and family responsibilities before filling every available hour with promotion. Confirm links and materials, then decide what you can postpone if something changes. A realistic plan gives you a way to keep moving without treating every interruption as a disaster.

WORKSHEET

LAUNCH EMAILS AND OUTREACH TEMPLATES

Open your *Launch Emails and Outreach Templates* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use them to draft your announcement, personal introductions, and follow-up messages. Replace generic wording with details that fit the relationship and the reader. Make sure each message sounds like something you would actually say.

Your book is ready to meet people. Introduce it with pride, teach something useful, and pay attention to the conversations that follow. Launch week gives you a starting point. In the next chapter, we'll build the ongoing habits that keep your book reaching readers and supporting your business long after the first announcement.

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I didn't stop carrying my books because launch week was over. If I was meeting people who could benefit from my work, I wanted copies available. The book still explained my approach. It still gave someone a way to understand what I taught. A person discovering it months later didn't care that the announcement was old news to me. For them, it was new.

Remember that when the first burst of excitement settles down. You've answered congratulations, shared pictures, and perhaps signed your first copies. Wonderful. Now we need a routine that keeps introducing the book to suitable readers. We're continuing E in P.R.O.V.E.: Engage Your Future Clients. This chapter will help you plan the next ninety days and build habits you can carry into the months beyond.

TURN YOUR CHAPTERS INTO MONTHS OF USEFUL CONTENT

You don't need to invent something new every time you want to talk about your work. Open your book. Each chapter contains questions, explanations, examples, and activities you can teach in other formats. Choose one idea and consider how it could help someone

encountering you for the first time. Your manuscript gives you material worth returning to.

For our feedback example, one chapter might inspire a short video demonstrating an opening, an email about a common mistake, and a workshop exercise. Adapt each piece to its setting. A video can demonstrate tone, while a written example gives someone language to study. Keep each piece useful independently, then explain where the book offers more guidance.

Build a rhythm you can maintain. Perhaps you send one useful email each week and arrange one teaching opportunity each month. Choose a schedule that fits your capacity and audience. Consistency becomes easier when you know what you're teaching next. Plan several topics together, then leave room for questions that come from readers and clients.

Check older material before reusing it. Update examples, verify claims, and make sure links still work. Your book can continue introducing your expertise while your knowledge develops. Keep the content relevant to the problem you help solve. You don't have to comment on every trend simply because it appeared in your feed that morning.

YOUR BOOK CAN CONTINUE INTRODUCING YOUR EXPERTISE WHILE YOUR KNOWLEDGE DEVELOPS.

USE AMAZON ADS WITH A BUDGET AND A PLAN

Amazon ads can help put your book in front of potential readers, but attention costs money. Sponsored Products use a cost-per-click model: you pay when somebody clicks, whether or not they buy. Amazon offers targeting options that can connect ads with relevant searches or products. Learn the current controls before starting, and choose targets that fit your book.

Begin with a test budget you can afford and a question you want to investigate. You might test whether a small group of relevant

search phrases attracts buyers. Record your settings and review the results regularly. Read how the campaign's budgeting and bidding options operate instead of assuming every setting works the way its name sounds.

Understand the difference between reported book sales and your royalties. Suppose, hypothetically, you spend thirty dollars on ads and sell ten copies earning three dollars each. Those royalties cover the advertising spend, before other business costs. They don't create thirty dollars of profit. Work with your actual royalty figures and the orders associated with the campaign.

Watch spending, clicks, orders, and the relevance of the traffic. Allow for the reporting delays described in the platform, and avoid making sweeping conclusions from a tiny sample. If clicks accumulate without purchases, investigate the targeting and listing. Don't keep increasing the budget because you're hoping one future coaching client will somehow justify every expense.

Advertising is optional. You can build opportunities through teaching, relationships, and outreach while learning whether paid promotion suits your economics. If you hire someone to manage ads, agree on the budget, reporting, responsibilities, and review schedule. You should still understand what is being spent and what the available evidence says about the results.

GET YOUR BOOK INTO THE RIGHT HANDS

Think about organizations already serving your intended readers. Professional associations, employers, event organizers, and relevant communities may have reasons to introduce your material. Research the fit before reaching out. Explain the problem you address and a useful way you could contribute. Your proposal should make sense for their audience, not require them to invent a reason to feature you.

A workshop could include books for participants. An organization might purchase copies for a development program. A host might invite you to discuss a chapter relevant to their members. Clarify quantities, costs, delivery, and any teaching involved before making

commitments. Books and your time both have costs, even when the opportunity sounds exciting.

Use giveaways deliberately. Decide who the copies are for, what purpose they serve, and what you can afford. Include a relevant invitation without treating the gift as a debt. You can offer to answer questions or discuss suitable support. The recipient gets to choose whether they want to continue the conversation.

TRACK SALES, INQUIRIES, AND CLIENTS

Keep book performance and business opportunities visible without mixing every number together. Record copies sold, royalties, promotional expenses, resource requests, inquiries, and paid engagements. Each tells you something different. Plenty of downloads may show interest without indicating readiness to hire you. A small number of relevant inquiries might deserve more attention than a busy post.

Ask new contacts how they found you and what prompted them to reach out. Someone may have heard you speak, received the book from a colleague, and read several emails before contacting you. Record that sequence where they can describe it. Don't assign all the credit to one activity simply because it was the easiest thing to measure.

Review the information monthly. Which efforts reached suitable people? Which produced useful conversations? What cost more time or money than you expected? Choose a small number of adjustments for the next month. You want enough consistency to learn while being willing to stop activities that aren't serving the book or the business.

LET YOUR READERS HELP YOU CHOOSE WHAT COMES NEXT

After publishing, I became interested in creating more books. You may feel that same excitement. Before starting the next manuscript, listen to what readers ask after applying your method. Their questions may reveal a need for deeper instruction, a companion

resource, or help with a related problem. Collect those questions instead of deciding immediately that each deserves another book.

Some needs belong in an update to the existing manuscript. Others might justify a workbook, journal, workshop, or separate title. Ask what the format would help people do. A workbook should support useful practice, and a journal needs a purpose beyond providing lined pages. Give every addition a job within the reader's progress.

Keep supporting the book you've already created while evaluating the next opportunity. Starting something new can feel easier than continuing promotion, especially when results are slower than you hoped. Check whether the proposed project serves a real need and whether you have capacity to deliver it. Let reader evidence and your business priorities guide the decision.

ACTIVITY

CREATE YOUR 90-DAY POST-LAUNCH PLAN

Open your workbook and divide the next ninety days into three monthly blocks. For each month, choose a teaching theme from the book, one outreach priority, and a review date. Set a realistic spending limit and reserve time for responding to interested readers.

- **Month one:** Establish a manageable content and follow-up routine.
- **Month two:** Continue useful activities and test one relevant opportunity.
- **Month three:** Review results and decide what to continue or change.
- **Weekly:** Share useful teaching and respond to agreed follow-ups.
- **Monthly:** Review sales, expenses, inquiries, and client conversations.
- **Throughout:** Record recurring questions and ideas for improving the book.

Write down who is responsible for each action and what completion looks like. If an activity requires money, specify the budget before starting. At the end of ninety days, use what you've learned to plan the next period. You don't need to predict an entire year before taking the next sensible step.

Plan beyond this first cycle by noting relevant conferences, seasonal needs, or organizational planning periods over the coming year. Approach opportunities early enough to prepare well. Leave space to rest and serve existing clients, too. A promotional routine that only works when you neglect everything else won't support the freedom you wanted from building this business.

WORKSHEET

BOOK-TO-BUSINESS RESULTS TRACKER

Open your *Book-to-Business Results Tracker* from the worksheets page linked in the Introduction. Use it to record promotion, costs, reader responses, and opportunities in one place. Add context beside the numbers so you remember what happened and can make useful comparisons over time.

Your book can keep introducing your expertise long after publication day. Keep teaching, keep listening, and make it easy for suitable readers to continue with you. You've worked through P.R.O.V.E., from choosing the problem to engaging future clients. Now give those decisions a place in your ordinary working week. That's how this becomes part of your business.

When I landed in Canada at 4 a.m. with 2 little kids, 13 pieces of luggage, 2 strollers, and 2 car seats, I couldn't see the life I would eventually build. I wanted to get home. I needed to take care of my children and figure out what came next. Somewhere underneath the exhaustion, though, there was still that thought: I need to write my book.

I carried that thought through years of working, commuting, and parenting. The knowledge was there. I knew how to train leaders, and I wanted to capture the way I helped people learn. Finding the time was another matter. When my routine changed during COVID, I used the hours I gained to write. Eventually, the book that had lived in my head became something I could put in somebody else's hands.

Then, on February 7, 2022, my book went live and my corporate job ended. I had a decision to make, and I chose to go back to consulting. I trusted God and took the next step without knowing exactly how everything would unfold. The book helped people understand my work. Conversations followed, clients came, and I began building a business around the expertise I already had.

Your circumstances will be different. You may have a business, a job you enjoy, or a schedule that leaves very little room for another project. You don't need my story to happen to you before you can begin. Start with the knowledge you have, the people you can help, and the practical choices available to you. This book has given you a process for making those choices.

BRING YOUR P.R.O.V.E. PLAN TOGETHER

Go back to P: Pinpoint the Problem. Who is your reader, and what do they need help doing? You should be able to describe their situation clearly enough that they recognize themselves. If you're still saying your book is for everyone, return to the conversations and research. Choose one problem that matters to a specific audience and that your expertise can meaningfully address.

Then look at R: Reveal Your Method. Have you turned what you know into a process someone can follow? Check the sequence, examples, exercises, and progress checks. Remember how much you normally explain in a room without thinking about it. Your reader needs that guidance on the page. Make the instructions clear enough to use when you aren't there to answer questions.

With O: Offer the Evidence, examine how you support your teaching. Your experience, client cases, demonstrations, and relevant research can help readers understand your approach. Present them honestly and explain the context. Listen to early readers and fix what confuses them. You want the book to earn trust through useful teaching and credible support, with promises that match what it delivers.

Return to V: Value Your Expertise. What can a suitable reader hire you to help them do? Define the outcome, the work involved, the boundaries, and the price. Make sure the offer fits your capacity and the life you're building. You deserve to understand your own commitments as clearly as the client does. A thoughtful offer gives an interested reader something concrete to consider.

Finally, review E: Engage Your Future Clients. How will people discover the book, experience your teaching, and continue with you

if they need support? Check the launch plan, the resources, the invitations, and the follow-up. Keep introducing the work after publication week. Someone encountering your book six months from now can still become a reader, a referral, or a client.

Put those five decisions together on one page. Read them as a connected plan. Does the method address the problem? Does the evidence support the promise? Does the paid offer extend the teaching in a useful way? Do your promotional activities reach the intended reader? Wherever the connection feels weak, identify the next adjustment. You now have a way to review the whole project.

CHOOSE THE NEXT THING YOU WILL FINISH

Finishing this book can feel productive. You've gathered ideas, perhaps highlighted passages, and imagined your own cover. I hope you're excited. But before you close it, decide what you'll complete next. Choose something you can point to when it's done: an interview with a potential reader, a method map, a chapter draft, or a conversation with an editor.

Look at your current stage instead of comparing yourself with somebody who's already publishing their fifth book. If you haven't chosen a problem, a launch calendar probably isn't today's assignment. If the manuscript is ready, you may need to arrange formatting or order a proof. Work on the decision that allows the next part of the project to move forward.

Give that task a place in your calendar. Decide what you need, how much time you can reasonably protect, and what completion will look like. Tell someone supportive if that helps you follow through. Keep the commitment manageable enough to honor. Progress becomes easier to recognize when you're completing specific pieces instead of carrying "write my book" around as one enormous obligation.

There will be interruptions. Children need things. Clients call. You get tired, something takes longer than expected, and your beautifully planned afternoon disappears. Adjust the schedule and return to the work. You haven't ruined the project because a week

went differently from the plan. Look at what remains possible and choose the next session you can protect.

As you move forward, keep a record of what you finish and what you learn. On a difficult day, those notes can remind you that the project has moved. A clearer promise, a completed chapter, and a useful conversation are all pieces of the book you're steadily building.

KEEP THE BUSINESS CONNECTED TO THE LIFE YOU WANT

I wanted freedom. I wanted to use my experience, serve people, and work from home, wherever that happened to be. Publishing became part of that life. Think about what you're trying to build. More clients may be useful, but the type of work, the demands on your time, and the way you deliver it matter just as much.

Your book can introduce your expertise while you're busy doing other things. It still needs care, promotion, and a clear connection to your services. Keep reviewing whether those activities support your goals. If an offer fills your calendar with work you can't sustain, adjust it. If a promotional routine leaves you exhausted, simplify it before you abandon the whole effort.

You can ask for help. Editors, designers, formatters, and other professionals can contribute skills you don't need to master yourself. Understand the work you're commissioning, agree on expectations, and keep responsibility for the final result. Getting support can help you finish well while preserving time for the teaching and client work you do best.

REMEMBER THE PERSON HOLDING YOUR BOOK

Picture someone finding your book on a day when the problem feels especially frustrating. They might read during a commute, between meetings, or after everyone else has gone to bed. They want help they can understand. Your explanation, example, or exercise could give them a practical place to begin. Keep that person in mind when you're tempted to make everything sound more impressive.

Some readers will apply what you teach independently. Some will share the book with a colleague. Others may invite you to speak or ask about working together. You won't know every way the book helps. Deliver useful work anyway. Make the next step easy to find and let people decide how they want to continue.

I was the same person before and after publishing. The experience was already there. The book gave people a way to see it, spend time with it, and understand why they might want my help. You have an opportunity to do that with your own expertise. Give your knowledge a form that people can read, use, and pass along.

I WAS THE SAME PERSON BEFORE AND AFTER PUBLISHING. THE BOOK GAVE PEOPLE A WAY TO SEE IT."

You don't have to feel completely ready before taking a sensible next step. You do need to take responsibility for the quality of what you publish and the promises you make. Keep learning, check the work, and let feedback improve it. Your first book can be the beginning of a body of work that develops with you and the people you serve.

Before you leave, write down the task you've chosen and the date you'll work on it. Open your workbook and put the materials you need somewhere easy to find. Make the return to this project simple. You've spent enough time wondering whether you have something worth sharing. Now you have a process for developing it into something useful.

When the time comes, hold your book, sign the copies, and enjoy what you've accomplished. If you want the special pen, you know where I stand on that. Then keep introducing your work to the people it can help. I hope you build something you're proud of and a business that gives you room to live.

Let's show them what you've got. Your next step is waiting.

FROM KARINA

A MESSAGE FROM THE AUTHOR

You made it to the end. Most people don't. (They read and nod, remember?)

So here's what I know for sure: there is no better way to grow your business than a book that does for you what my book did for me.

A book that becomes a client magnet, bringing the right people straight into your business. No cold calling. No worrying about where your next client is coming from.

If that's the book you want, book your call with me. In 45 minutes, we'll:

- Figure out where you are with your book right now
- Build your launch plan, step by step
- Map out a book you'll be proud of, the kind you take everywhere and send to everyone

Picture it. You walk into a meeting with any director, your book in your hand, proud. Ready to land that next consulting gig.

That's what I want for you.

> **Book your call at calendly.com/karina-1-on-1/45min and let's show them what you've got!**

Karina

45-MINUTE DISCOVERY CALL

WANT A BOOK THAT WILL GET YOU BOOKED?

Fill your calendar with clients who ALREADY TRUST YOU.
No cold calls. No chasing or awkward DMs required.



SCAN TO BOOK YOUR CALL

Let's figure out where you're at and build your launch plan for a book you'll be proud to take to every meeting.

Or type this into your browser:

calendly.com/karina-1-on-1/45min

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